

## ENGLISH FOR RETAIL AND DIGITAL COMMERCE TEAMS

# Retail and E-Commerce English

Explain the offer. Trace the order. Make the numbers meaningful.

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**Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.**

**INSIDE THE BOOK**

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For merchandising, digital trading, inventory, fulfillment, customer service, and store operations teams.

2026 edition

# Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight commercial conversations: compare ranges, examine a promotion, locate sellable stock, explain a delivery delay, investigate checkout performance, challenge a vendor scorecard, handle a return request, and repair a pickup handoff.

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# Connect the commercial claim to the customer experience

Retail teams move between units, orders, prices, stock states, and customer promises. These conversations practice making each distinction clear while keeping the next action useful.

## Name the measure before the result

Revenue, gross profit, units, and conversion answer different questions. State the denominator and comparison period before drawing a conclusion.

"Units increased, but gross profit fell on the stated cost basis."

## Locate the stock behind the promise

A national total does not establish availability at a pickup store. Check the item, location, inventory state, and fulfillment route.

"Thirty units are available at the warehouse; this store has none."

## Make uncertainty useful

An honest delivery update combines the latest verified status with a named next step. Do not turn an estimated arrival into a guarantee.

"The carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time; I will update you at two."

## Separate authority from empathy

Acknowledge the inconvenience without inventing a refund, replacement, or policy exception. Explain available review routes and applicable customer rights.

"I can submit the exception request, but I cannot approve it myself."

### PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All companies, customers, products, figures, and local procedures are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not legal, accounting, or operational advice. Actual consumer rights, return obligations, marketplace terms, and shipping requirements depend on the transaction and jurisdiction. Store policies do not override applicable rights. Software terminology varies by platform.

# Equal revenue, different stock exposure

## A Read the situation

**Compare product ranges using a defined sell-through measure and a balanced buying recommendation.**

During the same four-week season, Range A sold 80 of its 100 opening units for \$12,000. Range B sold 120 of its 200 opening units, also for \$12,000. There were no receipts, returns, or stock adjustments. A sold at full price; B required markdowns. For this review, unit sell-through means units sold divided by opening units. Buyer Inez and planner Cal must discuss next season without assuming that equal revenue means equal performance. Product costs and customer-segment evidence are not yet available.

PEOPLE / Inez: Buyer | Cal: Merchandise planner

### CHALLENGE THE MEASURE, NOT THE BUYER

A range can matter for customer choice even when its stock turns slowly. Recognize that commercial purpose, then identify the missing evidence. A precise question about margin or remaining stock is more useful than calling a colleague's selection a failure.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Range A's sell-through under the stated definition?

- |               |              |
|---------------|--------------|
| <b>A</b> 60%  | <b>B</b> 40% |
| <b>C</b> 120% | <b>D</b> 80% |

2. How many units remain in Range B?

- |              |              |
|--------------|--------------|
| <b>A</b> 80  | <b>B</b> 20  |
| <b>C</b> 120 | <b>D</b> 200 |

3. What is not yet established?

- |                                              |                                              |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> Range B used markdowns              | <b>B</b> Range A sold 80 units               |
| <b>C</b> Which range has higher gross profit | <b>D</b> Both ranges earned \$12,000 revenue |

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### assortment

The selection of products offered to customers.

**IN USE review the assortment**

### range

A related group of products offered for sale.

**IN USE compare product ranges**

### stock-keeping unit (SKU)

An internal identifier for a specific stocked item or variant.

**IN USE rationalize the SKU count**

### sell-through

Units sold as a proportion of a defined stock base.

**IN USE calculate unit sell-through**

### opening stock

Inventory held at the start of a period.

**IN USE establish opening stock**

### residual stock

Inventory remaining after the measured selling period.

**IN USE reduce residual stock**

### markdown

A reduction from an earlier selling price.

**IN USE take a markdown**

### full-price sale

A sale at the regular undiscounted price.

**IN USE protect full-price sales**

### option count

The number of distinct product choices in a range.

**IN USE review the option count**

### assortment breadth

The variety of categories or product choices offered.

**IN USE broaden the assortment**

### assortment depth

The quantity or variety held within a selected line.

**IN USE adjust assortment depth**

### size curve

The planned distribution of units across sizes.

**IN USE revise the size curve**

### Precision check

Sell-through definitions differ. This case uses units sold divided by opening units, with no other stock movements. A is 80%; B is 60%. Do not quietly substitute revenue or remaining units as the denominator.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## **B** Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### colorway

A particular color version of a product.

**IN USE** add a colorway

### core line

A recurring product line central to the offer.

**IN USE** replenish a core line

### seasonal line

A line intended for a particular selling season.

**IN USE** exit a seasonal line

### range review

A structured assessment of the product selection.

**IN USE** conduct a range review

### buying budget

Funds allocated to purchasing merchandise.

**IN USE** protect the buying budget

### open-to-buy

A planned merchandise purchasing allowance after commitments.

**IN USE** check open-to-buy

### stock turn

A measure of how frequently inventory is sold or replaced.

**IN USE** compare stock turn

### weeks of cover

Stock expressed in weeks at a specified sales rate.

**IN USE** assess weeks of cover

### gross margin return on inventory

Gross profit relative to average inventory cost.

**IN USE** evaluate inventory return

### delist

Remove an item from the active product selection.

**IN USE** propose a delisting

### range rationalization

Simplifying the assortment using stated commercial criteria.

**IN USE** support range rationalization

### customer segment

A group of customers with relevant shared characteristics.

**IN USE** serve a customer segment

### Precision check

Equal sales revenue does not establish equal gross profit or inventory return. Costs, timing, stock investment, and the role of each range matter. A recommendation can identify further analysis without pretending the final buying decision is settled.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 1 of 2

### OPEN THE COMPARISON

"Both ranges generated \$12,000 in the same four weeks."

### STATE THE STRONGER RATE

"Range A sold through at eighty percent."

### ACKNOWLEDGE THE COMMERCIAL ROLE

"B may serve a different customer segment."

### IDENTIFY THE PRICE EFFECT

"B reached the same revenue with markdowns."

### DEFINE THE MEASURE

"Here, sell-through uses units sold divided by opening stock."

### STATE THE REMAINING EXPOSURE

"Range B still has eighty units on hand."

### SEPARATE UNITS AND REVENUE

"More units sold does not necessarily mean more revenue."

### ASK FOR THE MISSING BASIS

"Can we add product costs before comparing gross profit?"

---

### At full price

Describes the transaction price, not automatically a higher profit.

### Sold through at

Introduces a rate with an explicitly defined stock base.

### Subject to

Makes the recommendation conditional on named evidence.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

### **AVOID AN AUTOMATIC DECISION**

"This is not enough evidence to delist the whole range."

### **PROTECT A USEFUL DISTINCTION**

"The rate is lower even though unit sales are higher."

### **LIMIT THE RECOMMENDATION**

"I recommend a more targeted buy, subject to the missing evidence."

### **PRESERVE THE CUSTOMER QUESTION**

"We still need to understand which customers bought B."

### **NARROW THE NEXT REVIEW**

"Let us examine B by size and colorway."

### **REQUEST COMPARABLE PERIODS**

"Keep both ranges on the same four-week basis."

### **CLARIFY COMMITMENT**

"A proposal is not a released purchase order."

### **SUMMARIZE THE TRADE-OFF**

"The same revenue came with different stock and price exposure."

---

### **Even though**

Connects a higher unit count with a lower sell-through rate.

### **By size and colorway**

Narrows analysis to commercially useful product variants.

### **Not enough evidence**

Challenges the conclusion without dismissing the data.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which comparison is accurate?

- A** A sold 80% of opening units; B sold 60%.
- B** A sold fewer units, so its sell-through must be lower.
- C** Both sell-through rates are equal because revenue is equal.
- D** B sold 120%, using A's opening stock.

### 2. Which claim needs product costs?

- A** B required markdowns.
- B** A earned more gross profit than B.
- C** B sold 120 units.
- D** A had 20 units remaining.

### 3. Which recommendation is appropriately limited?

- A** Double B solely because it sold more units.
- B** Treat equal revenue as proof of equal inventory return.
- C** Review B by variant and customer segment before changing the buy.
- D** Delist every B item because one period proves no demand.

### 4. Which wording states a condition?

- A** The review guarantees higher future sales.
- B** We can revise the buy once the cost and variant review is complete.
- C** We have already released the order.
- D** Every missing cost is zero.

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

# Equal revenue, different stock exposure

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

markdown / residual stock / sell-through / size curve / range review / delisting / buying budget / assortment depth / gross margin return on inventory / customer segment

- 01 **Inez:** Both ranges made twelve thousand dollars. I am inclined to keep the buying quantities unchanged, although B needed more promotional support than we expected.
- 02 **Cal:** Before we repeat the buy, look at <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. A sold eighty of one hundred units; B sold one hundred twenty of two hundred. That gives eighty percent and sixty percent respectively.
- 03 **Inez:** B did sell forty more units. I do not want the team to lose sight of that demand when we review the range.
- 04 **Cal:** Agreed, but B also leaves more <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. We have eighty units remaining there, compared with twenty in A. Those units still need a commercial plan.
- 05 **Inez:** We reached the same revenue through different prices. A held its regular price, while B required reductions during the season.
- 06 **Cal:** Exactly. The <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ helped B move units, but we cannot judge the profit effect properly without product costs. The revenue line alone will not settle that question.
- 07 **Inez:** Should we remove B completely? That would release buying budget, but it might also leave a gap for a customer group we serve.
- 08 **Cal:** I would not recommend an immediate <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. First, separate B by size and colorway. An aggregate result can hide strong variants alongside weak ones.
- 09 **Inez:** Some sizes may be carrying the leftovers. We should see whether the original distribution matched what customers actually selected.
- 10 **Cal:** Then review the <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. That may support changing quantities within the range rather than removing every option. We need the variant-level data before deciding.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Inez:** I also want to know whether B attracts customers who rarely buy A. Equal revenue does not tell us whether the ranges overlap.
- 12 **Cal:** Yes, include the <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ evidence. We should not describe B as unnecessary until we understand its role. That is a separate question from this period's lower rate.
- 13 **Inez:** Could we call for a smaller initial order, with more room to react later?
- 14 **Cal:** We can propose that within the <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_, but supplier lead times and minimum quantities still need checking. Flexibility on paper is not always available in the supply arrangement.
- 15 **Inez:** Let us keep the recommendation conditional and show the remaining inventory separately.
- 16 **Cal:** I will add <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ once we have the required cost and average-stock information. I will not manufacture it from these sales totals.
- 17 **Inez:** Good. Keep the four-week dates visible so we do not compare a full season with a partial one.
- 18 **Cal:** The <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ will show common dates, both denominators, the price reductions, and the outstanding analysis. That makes the recommendation easier to challenge constructively.
- 19 **Inez:** Our next move is a targeted review, not a repeat order or a blanket removal.
- 20 **Cal:** Correct. We can revisit <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ after the evidence is complete. For now, equal revenue is the starting observation, not the final buying decision.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. sell-through | 2. residual stock | 3. markdown | 4. delisting | 5. size curve | 6. customer segment | 7. buying budget | 8. gross margin return on inventory | 9. range review | 10. assortment depth

# Compare a second pair of ranges

## F Say it

Range C sells 45 of 60 opening units. Range D sells 60 of 120 opening units. There are no other stock movements. Use the same unit sell-through definition.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

60 / 75% / 50% / 15

Buyer: "C has a sell-through rate of <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Planner: "D has a sell-through rate of <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Buyer: "C has <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ units remaining."

Planner: "D has <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ units remaining."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. 75% | 2. 50% | 3. 15 | 4. 60

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit

## A Read the situation

**Explain price-volume arithmetic and challenge a profit claim without dismissing the promotion goal.**

In the baseline week, a product sold 100 units at \$50 each. During the promotion it sold 120 units at \$42.50 each, a 15% price reduction. Product cost remained \$30 per unit. These are complete comparable weekly sales with no returns. Taxes, shipping income, operating expenses, and other promotional costs are excluded. Trading manager Hugo says the 20% unit increase proves that profit improved. Finance partner Nia must correct that claim and separate the measured result from other possible campaign objectives.

PEOPLE / Hugo: Trading manager | Nia: Finance partner

### KEEP THE SUCCESS CRITERION EXPLICIT

A promotional team may emphasize traffic or new customers while finance emphasizes margin. Name the objective being tested. Correcting the arithmetic does not require calling the entire campaign a failure; other benefits need their own evidence.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What was promotion revenue?

- A \$5,100
- C \$4,250

- B \$6,000
- D \$5,000

2. What was promotion gross profit on the stated basis?

- A \$2,400
- C \$1,500

- B \$5,100
- D \$2,000

3. Which cost is excluded?

- A The \$30 unit product cost
- C Cost of baseline units sold

- B Cost of all 120 units sold
- D Operating expenses

Answers and explanations: page 78.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### selling price

The amount charged per unit before specified adjustments.

**IN USE** set the selling price

### unit volume

The number of units sold during a period.

**IN USE** increase unit volume

### sales revenue

Income from the measured sales before the stated costs.

**IN USE** calculate sales revenue

### cost of goods sold

Product costs attributable to the units sold.

**IN USE** deduct cost of goods sold

### gross profit

Sales revenue less cost of goods sold.

**IN USE** protect gross profit

### gross margin percentage

Gross profit divided by sales revenue, expressed as a percentage.

**IN USE** calculate gross margin percentage

### price reduction

A decrease in the selling price.

**IN USE** apply a price reduction

### promotional uplift

An increase against a defined nonpromotional comparison.

**IN USE** measure promotional uplift

### baseline

The reference level used for comparison.

**IN USE** establish a baseline

### incremental revenue

Additional revenue relative to the defined comparison.

**IN USE** estimate incremental revenue

### unit gross profit

Selling price less the stated product cost per unit.

**IN USE** compare unit gross profit

### contribution margin

Revenue less the variable costs included in its definition.

**IN USE** define contribution margin

### Precision check

Units rose 20%, while price fell 15%. Revenue changes multiplicatively: 1.20 times 0.85 equals 1.02, a 2% increase. Subtracting the two percentages would incorrectly give 5%.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### price elasticity

The responsiveness of quantity demanded to price changes.

**IN USE** estimate price elasticity

### cannibalization

Sales gained by one offer at another offer's expense.

**IN USE** assess cannibalization

### halo effect

A related benefit beyond the promoted product itself.

**IN USE** test for a halo effect

### basket value

The monetary value of a customer's purchase basket.

**IN USE** increase basket value

### average order value

Revenue divided by the relevant order count.

**IN USE** monitor average order value

### discount depth

The size of a price reduction against its reference.

**IN USE** compare discount depth

### redemption rate

The proportion using an offer among a defined eligible base.

**IN USE** calculate redemption rate

### promotion mechanic

The structure by which an offer operates.

**IN USE** explain the promotion mechanic

### funding allowance

A contribution toward promotion costs under agreed terms.

**IN USE** verify a funding allowance

### price override

An authorized change from the system's listed selling price.

**IN USE** approve a price override

### break-even volume

Units required to meet a specified cost or profit threshold.

**IN USE** calculate break-even volume

### margin dilution

A reduction in the relevant profit margin.

**IN USE** quantify margin dilution

### Precision check

Baseline gross profit is \$2,000; promotion gross profit is \$1,500, down 25%. This is not net profit. Gross margin percentage falls from 40% to approximately 29.4% under the stated cost exclusions.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 1 of 2

### ACKNOWLEDGE VOLUME

"The promotion sold twenty percent more units."

### STATE THE NEW PRICE

"The promotional price was \$42.50."

### CALCULATE REVENUE

"One hundred twenty times \$42.50 gives \$5,100."

### SHOW THE UNIT EFFECT

"Unit gross profit fell from twenty dollars to \$12.50."

### CORRECT THE INFERENCE

"That does not by itself establish higher profit."

### KEEP THE COST BASIS

"Product cost stayed at thirty dollars per unit."

### SEPARATE THE MEASURES

"Revenue rose two percent; gross profit fell twenty-five percent."

### NAME THE EXCLUSION

"This calculation excludes operating and promotional expenses."

---

### By itself

Restricts what one measure can prove.

### From ... to ...

Makes the original and new values explicit.

### Excludes

Names costs or revenues outside the calculation.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 2 of 2

### DEFINE THE MARGIN

"Gross margin percentage uses revenue as its denominator."

### RECOGNIZE ANOTHER OBJECTIVE

"New-customer acquisition would need a separate measure."

### LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"These figures do not establish net profitability."

### PROTECT THE BASELINE

"Use the same product and comparable periods."

### AVOID A FALSE SHORTCUT

"The price and volume changes must be multiplied."

### ASK ABOUT FUNDING

"Has any supplier allowance actually been agreed?"

### EXPLAIN THE THRESHOLD

"At \$12.50 per unit, 160 units would match the prior gross profit."

### CLOSE THE REVIEW

"Let us report the volume gain and the margin cost together."

---

### Approximately

Marks a rounded percentage, not an exact value.

### Would match

States a conditional threshold, not an achieved result.

### Actually agreed

Distinguishes confirmed funding from hoped-for support.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

**1.** Which statement correctly combines the price and volume effects?

- A** Revenue rose 20%.
- B** Revenue fell 15%.
- C** Revenue rose 2%.
- D** Revenue rose 5%.

**2.** What happened to gross profit?

- A** It increased to \$5,100.
- B** It stayed at \$2,000.
- C** It increased 20% with units.
- D** It fell from \$2,000 to \$1,500.

**3.** How many promotional units would match baseline gross profit?

- A** 100
- B** 120
- C** 150
- D** 160

**4.** Which claim goes beyond the supplied evidence?

- A** Product cost remained \$30 per unit.
- B** Promotion revenue was \$5,100.
- C** Gross profit fell on the stated basis.
- D** The campaign acquired profitable new customers.

Answers and explanations: page 78.

# A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

gross margin percentage / unit volume / gross profit / funding allowance / margin dilution / break-even volume / unit gross profit / Sales revenue / cost of goods sold / baseline

- 01 **Hugo:** We sold twenty percent more units during the promotion. I want to describe it as a profit improvement in the weekly trading note.
- 02 **Nia:** The <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ improved, but the price fell. Let us calculate the money result before choosing that wording. We sold one hundred twenty units at forty-two dollars fifty.
- 03 **Hugo:** That gives five thousand one hundred dollars, compared with five thousand in the normal week.
- 04 **Nia:** Correct. <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ increased two percent. We multiply the quantity and price factors, rather than subtracting fifteen percent from twenty percent and calling the difference five.
- 05 **Hugo:** Revenue is still higher. Why would that not support the profit claim?
- 06 **Nia:** Because <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ also increased with the extra units. At thirty dollars per unit, it was three thousand dollars before and three thousand six hundred during the promotion.
- 07 **Hugo:** So we subtract those product costs from the revenue in each week.
- 08 **Nia:** Yes. That gives <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ of two thousand dollars before and fifteen hundred during the promotion. On that measure, the result fell twenty-five percent despite the higher revenue.
- 09 **Hugo:** We should also explain why each sale contributed less before the other costs.
- 10 **Nia:** The <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ fell from twenty dollars to twelve dollars fifty. We would need one hundred sixty promotional units to match the previous two thousand dollars.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Hugo:** We sold only one hundred twenty, so we did not reach that threshold.
- 12 **Nia:** Right. This <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is defined as matching the prior gross profit, not covering every business expense. The definition needs to stay next to the number.
- 13 **Hugo:** Could traffic or new customers still make the promotion worthwhile?
- 14 **Nia:** Possibly, but those goals need evidence beyond this <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ comparison. We have no new-customer or repeat-purchase data here. A possible benefit should not be presented as a measured result.
- 15 **Hugo:** I heard the supplier might support the offer. Should we add that to the calculation?
- 16 **Nia:** Only if the <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is confirmed and accounted for on the correct basis. At present, these figures contain no agreed supplier contribution. Keep that possibility separate.
- 17 **Hugo:** What percentage should the margin line show?
- 18 **Nia:** The <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is approximately twenty-nine point four percent, down from forty. That is a revenue-based ratio, not the twenty-five-percent change in gross profit dollars.
- 19 **Hugo:** I will report the volume gain and the lower gross profit, then list customer acquisition as an unanswered question.
- 20 **Nia:** Good. Describe the <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ clearly without declaring every campaign objective a failure. We can assess the wider decision when the additional evidence is available.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. unit volume | 2. Sales revenue | 3. cost of goods sold | 4. gross profit | 5. unit gross profit | 6. break-even volume | 7. baseline | 8. funding allowance | 9. gross margin percentage | 10. margin dilution

# Calculate another promotion result

## F Say it

A product sells 50 units at \$80 in the baseline period and 60 units at \$70 in the promotion. Product cost is \$50 per unit. Exclude all other costs and returns.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

4,200 / 4,000 / 1,500 / 1,200

Manager: "Baseline revenue was <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

Analyst: "Promotion revenue was <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

Manager: "Baseline gross profit was <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

Analyst: "Promotion gross profit was <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ dollars."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. 4,000 | 2. 4,200 | 3. 1,500 | 4. 1,200

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# The national total cannot promise store pickup

## A Read the situation

**Translate inventory states into an accurate location-specific availability message.**

At 09:00, SKU L42 has 100 units physically on hand at the central warehouse: 60 committed to existing orders, ten held for quality review, and 30 available for new sales. Twenty additional units are incoming and are not included in on-hand stock. Store East has no units. The website incorrectly uses the warehouse total to display pickup availability at Store East. Inventory controller Miro and digital trader Anika must correct the promise and check delivery eligibility before offering a warehouse fulfillment route.

PEOPLE / Miro: Inventory controller | Anika: Digital trader

### ASK WHICH STOCK NUMBER THE TEAM MEANS

Merchandising, stores, and digital teams may all say available while referring to different records. Repeat the location and status instead of assuming agreement. This makes a correction collaborative and prevents a national total from becoming an unsupported local promise.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

**1.** How many warehouse units are available for new sales?

- |             |              |
|-------------|--------------|
| <b>A</b> 30 | <b>B</b> 100 |
| <b>C</b> 60 | <b>D</b> 120 |

**2.** How many incoming units are included in the on-hand total?

- |              |               |
|--------------|---------------|
| <b>A</b> 20  | <b>B</b> 30   |
| <b>C</b> 100 | <b>D</b> None |

**3.** What is established for Store East?

- |                                                 |                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> Its replenishment has already arrived. | <b>B</b> It has no units.                           |
| <b>C</b> It has all 100 warehouse units.        | <b>D</b> It can offer immediate pickup of 30 units. |

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### on-hand inventory

Stock physically held at the stated location.

**IN USE reconcile on-hand inventory**

### available inventory

Stock eligible for new sales under the stated rules.

**IN USE confirm available inventory**

### committed inventory

Stock already allocated to existing demand.

**IN USE protect committed inventory**

### unavailable inventory

Held stock not currently eligible for sale.

**IN USE classify unavailable inventory**

### incoming inventory

Stock expected but not yet received into the location.

**IN USE track incoming inventory**

### quality hold

A restriction pending the applicable product-quality review.

**IN USE maintain a quality hold**

### allocation

Assignment of stock to a demand source or destination.

**IN USE revise the allocation**

### replenishment

Restocking to support future sales or demand.

**IN USE schedule replenishment**

### available to promise

Quantity that can be committed under defined fulfillment rules.

**IN USE calculate available to promise**

### stockout

Lack of the required sellable stock at a location.

**IN USE report a store stockout**

### location-level availability

Sellable stock information for a particular site.

**IN USE verify location-level availability**

### inventory feed

Data supplied to another system about stock quantities or states.

**IN USE correct the inventory feed**

### Precision check

On hand is not the same as available. Here the 100 warehouse units comprise 60 committed, ten held, and 30 available. The 20 incoming units are additional expected stock, not stock already received.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### safety stock

Stock held as a buffer against uncertainty.

**IN USE review safety stock**

### reorder point

The stock position that triggers replenishment under a policy.

**IN USE set a reorder point**

### lead time

Elapsed time between defined order and supply milestones.

**IN USE verify replenishment lead time**

### transfer order

A record authorizing movement between inventory locations.

**IN USE create a transfer order**

### cycle count

A targeted physical count of selected inventory.

**IN USE perform a cycle count**

### inventory adjustment

A recorded change to the system's stock quantity.

**IN USE authorize an inventory adjustment**

### overselling

Accepting demand beyond what can be fulfilled as promised.

**IN USE prevent overselling**

### backorder

Unfilled demand awaiting stock under the applicable arrangement.

**IN USE manage a backorder**

### fulfillment eligibility

Whether an item and location may serve a specified order.

**IN USE check fulfillment eligibility**

### stock reservation

Holding specified stock for a defined demand.

**IN USE confirm a stock reservation**

### inventory snapshot

Quantities and states captured at a particular time.

**IN USE timestamp the inventory snapshot**

### channel allocation

Assignment of inventory to particular sales channels.

**IN USE review channel allocation**

### Precision check

Warehouse availability does not establish store pickup or a delivery promise. Check location, item, eligibility, reservation, and timing under the actual process. An inventory snapshot can become stale as orders and stock movements occur.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

### IDENTIFY THE ITEM

"We are checking SKU L42."

### SEPARATE PHYSICAL AND SELLABLE STOCK

"One hundred units are on hand, but only thirty are available."

### RESPECT THE HOLD

"Ten units remain under quality review."

### STATE THE LOCAL POSITION

"Store East currently has no units."

### TIMESTAMP THE QUANTITY

"This is the inventory position at 09:00."

### PROTECT EXISTING ORDERS

"Sixty units are already committed."

### KEEP INCOMING STOCK SEPARATE

"Twenty units are incoming, not yet received."

### CORRECT THE PROMISE

"The warehouse total must not drive a ready-for-pickup message here."

---

### At 09:00

Fixes the time scope of a changing quantity.

### Already committed

Protects demand that has an existing allocation.

### Not yet received

Distinguishes incoming units from physically held stock.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

### CHECK THE ROUTE

"Can this warehouse fulfill this customer's delivery address?"

### REQUEST A FRESH CHECK

"Refresh the quantity before making the offer."

### KEEP THE HOLD INTACT

"Do not release held units just to cover the website promise."

### COORDINATE THE CORRECTION

"Update the customer-facing message and the underlying feed."

### AVOID AN ASSUMED RESERVATION

"Availability alone does not mean this order has reserved stock."

### NAME THE SYSTEM ISSUE

"The feed is using the wrong location and inventory state."

### LIMIT A TRANSFER CLAIM

"A proposed transfer is not a received replenishment."

### CLOSE WITH A VERIFIED OPTION

"Offer a delivery route only after eligibility is confirmed."

---

### Currently

Signals a present position, not a permanent stockout.

### Only after

Makes the offer conditional on the relevant check.

### Underlying feed

Names the data source, not merely the visible message.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which website claim is supported now?

- A** Held stock is available whenever demand is high.
- B** Store East has no stock for pickup.
- C** One hundred units are ready at Store East.
- D** All incoming units are ready for immediate sale.

### 2. Which arithmetic matches warehouse availability?

- A** 100 minus 10 equals 90 available.
- B** 100 minus 60 equals 40 available.
- C** 100 minus 60 minus 10 equals 30.
- D** 100 plus 20 equals 120 available.

### 3. Which step requires a separate check?

- A** Whether twenty units are incoming
- B** Whether the warehouse can fulfill the customer's delivery route
- C** Whether Store East currently has zero units
- D** Whether ten units are held

### 4. Which wording overstates a proposed transfer?

- A** A transfer needs the actual timing confirmed.
- B** The replenishment has arrived at Store East.
- C** We can review a transfer option.
- D** Store East has no units at this snapshot.

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

# The national total cannot promise store pickup

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

location-level availability / committed inventory / incoming inventory / quality hold / fulfillment eligibility / transfer order / inventory snapshot / stock reservation / on-hand inventory / inventory feed

- 01 **Anika:** The product page says Store East has one hundred units ready for pickup. The store team says it has none. Which record should we trust?
- 02 **Miro:** Start with the <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ at nine this morning. The hundred units belong to the central warehouse, not Store East. The page is drawing the wrong conclusion from that total.
- 03 **Anika:** Even at the warehouse, can we sell all one hundred to new customers?
- 04 **Miro:** No. That is <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Sixty are committed to existing orders, and ten are held for quality review. Only thirty remain available for new sales.
- 05 **Anika:** We also have twenty on the way. Someone added them to the website quantity.
- 06 **Miro:** Keep <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ separate. Those twenty have not been received. Adding them to current sellable stock would create a promise we cannot support from this snapshot.
- 07 **Anika:** Could we use the ten held units until the next shipment arrives?
- 08 **Miro:** The <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ remains in place. We cannot release them merely because the page overpromised. The correction must respect the actual stock states rather than make them fit the message.
- 09 **Anika:** And the sixty already assigned cannot be offered a second time.
- 10 **Miro:** Correct. Protect <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. We should not solve one customer promise by quietly taking stock from another order. The available balance here is thirty, not ninety or one hundred.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Anika:** I will remove the Store East pickup claim. Could we offer delivery from the warehouse instead?
- 12 **Miro:** First check <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Available stock does not prove that this warehouse serves the customer's address or that the order meets the route's conditions.
- 13 **Anika:** If the route works, should I describe those units as reserved for the customer?
- 14 **Miro:** Only after the actual <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is confirmed. Other orders may arrive after our snapshot. Refresh the quantity before offering a specific commitment.
- 15 **Anika:** That handles this customer. We also need to stop the same error on other product pages.
- 16 **Miro:** Review the <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. It needs the correct location and state, not just a national physical total. Otherwise the visible correction will be overwritten by the next update.
- 17 **Anika:** The store manager has asked for a warehouse transfer. Can we mark the store replenished?
- 18 **Miro:** Not yet. A <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is different from receipt. Check approval and timing, then update the store position when the relevant events actually occur.
- 19 **Anika:** I will show no pickup stock at East, check the warehouse delivery route, and raise the feed correction.
- 20 **Miro:** Good. Keep <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ visible in the handoff. That gives stores, digital trading, and customer service one accurate basis for the next conversation.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. inventory snapshot | 2. on-hand inventory | 3. incoming inventory | 4. quality hold | 5. committed inventory | 6. fulfillment eligibility | 7. stock reservation | 8. inventory feed | 9. transfer order | 10. location-level availability

# Read a second inventory snapshot

## F Say it

At Warehouse North, 80 units are on hand: 45 committed, five held, and the rest available. Twelve more are incoming. Store South has zero units.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

twelve / five / 30 / zero

Trader: "The available warehouse quantity is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Controller: "The held quantity is <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Trader: "The incoming quantity is <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Controller: "Store South's current quantity is <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. 30 | 2. five | 3. twelve | 4. zero

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# An expired estimate needs an honest next step

04

## A Read the situation

**Acknowledge a missed delivery estimate, distinguish shipment from arrival, and explain a concrete follow-up.**

Order R81 was physically handed to the carrier on 4 May. The customer was given an estimated arrival date of 6 May. It is now 7 May, and the carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time. Customer Laila needs the item for an event. Agent Tomas can open a carrier inquiry and give a status update at 14:00 today. No replacement dispatch, refund, or revised arrival is authorized in the supplied record. The team must check applicable customer rights and service remedies rather than invent a universal rule.

PEOPLE / Laila: Customer | Tomas: Customer service agent

### OWN THE COMMUNICATION WITHOUT INVENTING CONTROL

Customers need an accountable seller contact even when a carrier holds the parcel. Avoid blaming another company or offering vague reassurance. State the verified event, the unanswered question, and a follow-up you can actually deliver.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

### 1. What is confirmed?

**A** The carrier physically received the order on 4 May.

**C** A replacement has shipped.

**B** The order arrived on 6 May.

**D** A refund is approved.

### 2. What does 14:00 today represent?

**A** A replacement dispatch time

**C** A status update

**B** An automatic refund deadline

**D** Guaranteed delivery

### 3. What is unknown?

**A** The order reference

**C** The date of carrier handoff

**B** The original estimated date

**D** The revised arrival time

Answers and explanations: page 82.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### fulfillment

The process of preparing and completing an order's supply.

**IN USE track order fulfillment**

### dispatch

Sending goods from the seller's fulfillment operation.

**IN USE confirm dispatch**

### carrier handoff

Physical transfer of a parcel to the transport provider.

**IN USE verify carrier handoff**

### estimated delivery date

A projected arrival date rather than an unconditional guarantee.

**IN USE revise an estimated delivery date**

### tracking event

A recorded milestone in a shipment's movement.

**IN USE check the latest tracking event**

### carrier inquiry

A request for the transport provider to investigate a shipment.

**IN USE open a carrier inquiry**

### proof of delivery

A record supporting that delivery occurred.

**IN USE request proof of delivery**

### delivery exception

An event interrupting the expected delivery process.

**IN USE investigate a delivery exception**

### last mile

The final transport stage to the recipient.

**IN USE coordinate last-mile delivery**

### delivery window

A stated interval during which arrival is expected or scheduled.

**IN USE confirm the delivery window**

### service level

The defined standard or terms of a delivery service.

**IN USE verify the service level**

### consignment

Goods sent together under a transport arrangement.

**IN USE identify the consignment**

### Precision check

A shipping label alone does not prove carrier possession. This case does establish physical handoff. Shipment on 4 May still does not establish delivery on 6 May or any revised arrival time.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### tracking number

An identifier used to follow a shipment.

**IN USE** provide the tracking number

### split shipment

An order sent in separate deliveries.

**IN USE** explain a split shipment

### partial fulfillment

Supply of only part of an order.

**IN USE** record partial fulfillment

### delivery attempt

An effort to deliver at the specified address.

**IN USE** verify a delivery attempt

### return to sender

Routing a parcel back to the sending party.

**IN USE** investigate return to sender

### replacement order

An order created to supply a substitute for an earlier item.

**IN USE** authorize a replacement order

### refund authorization

Approval to return the relevant payment.

**IN USE** confirm refund authorization

### service recovery

Actions addressing a failure in the customer experience.

**IN USE** coordinate service recovery

### return authorization

Permission or reference for a return under a process.

**IN USE** issue a return authorization

### reverse logistics

Movement and handling of goods back from customers.

**IN USE** manage reverse logistics

### return inspection

Examination of returned goods under the applicable process.

**IN USE** complete a return inspection

### restocking fee

A charge associated with a return where applicable and lawful.

**IN USE** explain a restocking fee

### Precision check

An update promise must not become an arrival promise. Applicable shipment-delay obligations, in-transit remedies, and return rights require the actual transaction and jurisdiction; do not treat every delay as the same legal event.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 1 of 2

### ACKNOWLEDGE THE MISSED ESTIMATE

"The estimated date has passed, and you still do not have the order."

### STATE THE VERIFIED MILESTONE

"The carrier physically received the parcel on 4 May."

### TAKE THE NEXT ACTION

"I can open an inquiry with the carrier now."

### SEPARATE CONTACT AND ARRIVAL

"That is the update time, not a delivery guarantee."

### RECOGNIZE THE IMPACT

"I understand that you need the item for an event."

### AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED DATE

"I do not have a confirmed revised arrival time."

### OWN THE FOLLOW-UP

"I will update you today at 14:00."

### CHECK THE LATEST EVENT

"I will confirm what the tracking record actually shows."

---

### Physically received

Distinguishes possession from a label being generated.

### Estimated

Marks the stated arrival as a forecast, without erasing relevant obligations.

### I do not have

Identifies the present information gap directly.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 2 of 2

### AVOID BLAME

"I will remain your contact while we investigate."

### CHECK AVAILABLE OPTIONS

"I will review the applicable service remedies and customer rights."

### AVOID FALSE CERTAINTY

"The absence of a new scan does not prove the parcel is lost."

### PROVIDE AN HONEST UPDATE

"I will contact you even if the carrier has not answered."

### LIMIT THE REMEDY CLAIM

"No replacement has been authorized in this record."

### CONFIRM BEFORE PROMISING

"I need confirmation before giving a new arrival window."

### KEEP THE ORDER REFERENCE

"I will record the inquiry against R81."

### CLOSE WITH ACCOUNTABILITY

"The next message will state the latest position and outstanding action."

---

### Even if

Keeps the communication commitment valid while an answer is pending.

### No ... authorized

States the record's limits without deciding all possible remedies.

### Remain your contact

Maintains customer-facing ownership across another party's investigation.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which response is both honest and useful?

- A** The carrier has no confirmed new arrival; I will investigate and update you at 14:00.
- B** It will certainly arrive by 14:00.
- C** The carrier has it, so the seller has no further role.
- D** No scan proves it is permanently lost.

### 2. Which event proves shipment in this case?

- A** Creating a label
- B** An expected arrival on 6 May
- C** Promising an update on 7 May
- D** Physical carrier handoff on 4 May

### 3. Which promise is not supported?

- A** A replacement will arrive tomorrow.
- B** An inquiry can be opened.
- C** An update will be given today.
- D** The revised arrival is unconfirmed.

### 4. What should a pending-carrier update do?

- A** Invent a new date to sound decisive.
- B** Say the customer has no rights because the date was estimated.
- C** Avoid contacting the customer until delivery occurs.
- D** State that the reply is pending and identify the continuing action.

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

# An expired estimate needs an honest next step

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

delivery exception / carrier handoff / carrier inquiry / delivery window / replacement order / service recovery / estimated delivery date / tracking event / refund authorization / dispatch

- 01 **Laila:** My order was estimated for yesterday. I need it for an event, and the tracking page has not given me a new date.
- 02 **Tomas:** I am sorry the <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ has passed without the order reaching you. I can see R81, and I will check the actual shipment events rather than repeat the old date.
- 03 **Laila:** Does the record show that you sent it, or only that someone printed a label?
- 04 **Tomas:** It confirms <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ on the fourth of May. That is stronger than a label-created message, but it does not tell us when the parcel will reach your address.
- 05 **Laila:** The delivery was meant to be the sixth. Can you promise tomorrow instead?
- 06 **Tomas:** I cannot confirm a new <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ yet. The carrier has not supplied one. I would rather give you a verified update than another date that might cause you to make unreliable plans.
- 07 **Laila:** What can you do now? I do not want to be told simply to keep refreshing the website.
- 08 **Tomas:** I can open a <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and remain your contact. I will ask for the current location and the latest delivery position, then update you today at fourteen hundred.
- 09 **Laila:** Do you mean the order will arrive by two, or that you will contact me then?
- 10 **Tomas:** I mean I will contact you. The latest <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ may help explain the delay, but the update appointment is not an arrival promise. I will make that distinction clear in the note.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Laila:** Could you send another one now so that I have a backup?
- 12 **Tomas:** A <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ has not been authorized. I can review the available remedies under the actual order and service terms, including any applicable customer rights, before confirming an option.
- 13 **Laila:** I would also like to know whether a refund is possible if the item cannot meet my need.
- 14 **Tomas:** I will check that rather than invent a <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. The answer depends on the relevant facts and rights. I will record your event requirement so the review addresses the problem you actually face.
- 15 **Laila:** The missing scans worry me. Does that mean the parcel is lost?
- 16 **Tomas:** Not by itself. A <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ or a delayed update needs investigation. I do not have evidence that establishes loss, and I will not label the shipment delivered without support either.
- 17 **Laila:** Please contact me at two even if the carrier has not replied.
- 18 **Tomas:** I will. The <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ note will include your concern, the inquiry, and the outstanding answer. You should not have to start the explanation again with another agent.
- 19 **Laila:** Thank you. I need a clear position so I can decide what to do about the event.
- 20 **Tomas:** Understood. We will keep the verified <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ information separate from arrival and remedy decisions. My next contact is today at two, with the actual position even if some questions remain open.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. estimated delivery date | 2. carrier handoff | 3. delivery window | 4. carrier inquiry | 5. tracking event | 6. replacement order | 7. refund authorization | 8. delivery exception | 9. service recovery | 10. dispatch

# Give a second delayed-order update

## F Say it

Order V32 was handed to the carrier on 12 June. Its estimated arrival was 14 June. Today is 15 June. A new arrival time is unconfirmed; the agent will update the customer at 16:00.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

16:00 / 14 June / unconfirmed / 12 June

Agent: "Carrier handoff occurred on <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Customer: "The original estimated arrival was <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Agent: "The revised arrival time remains <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Customer: "The next status update is at <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. 12 June | 2. 14 June | 3. unconfirmed | 4. 16:00

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# A checkout decline with two competing explanations

## A Read the situation

**Report a conversion change accurately and distinguish an observed association from a causal claim.**

Before a checkout redesign, 400 of 1,000 eligible checkout sessions completed a purchase. Afterward, 320 of 1,000 did so. For this report, checkout conversion is completed purchasing sessions divided by eligible checkout sessions; one session counts at most once. A payment-provider outage also occurred in the later period. Event collection and traffic mix have not yet been verified as comparable. Product lead Mara and analyst Dev must explain the decline without claiming that the redesign alone caused it.

PEOPLE / Mara: Digital product lead | Dev: Commerce analyst

### MAKE A CHALLENGE TESTABLE

A design review can become personal when an unfavorable metric is treated as a verdict on the team. State the measured change, identify competing explanations, and request checks that can distinguish them. Avoid using uncertainty to dismiss a real decline.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the later conversion rate?

- A 40%
- C 20%

- B 8%
- D 32%

2. What is the absolute rate decline?

- A Eight percent relative
- C Thirty-two percentage points

- B Twenty percentage points
- D Eight percentage points

3. Which causal conclusion is established?

- A The redesign alone caused the decline.
- C The decline proves there was no measurement issue.

- B The outage explains every lost purchase.
- D The cause is not isolated by this before-and-after comparison.

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### checkout conversion

Completed purchasing sessions divided by the specified checkout-session base.

**IN USE** measure checkout conversion

### conversion funnel

The ordered steps toward a defined customer action.

**IN USE** examine the conversion funnel

### checkout abandonment

Failure to complete a purchase after entering checkout.

**IN USE** investigate checkout abandonment

### eligible session

A session meeting the stated inclusion criteria.

**IN USE** define eligible sessions

### purchase event

A recorded event representing a purchase action.

**IN USE** validate the purchase event

### event instrumentation

The implementation of event collection in a digital product.

**IN USE** audit event instrumentation

### duplicate event

An event recorded more than once for the same action.

**IN USE** remove duplicate events

### deduplication

Identifying and handling repeated records of the same event.

**IN USE** validate deduplication

### denominator

The base quantity used in a rate calculation.

**IN USE** keep the denominator consistent

### percentage point

One unit of difference between percentage rates.

**IN USE** report a percentage-point change

### relative change

A change expressed as a proportion of its initial value.

**IN USE** calculate relative change

### traffic mix

The composition of visitors by relevant source or characteristic.

**IN USE** compare traffic mix

### Precision check

The conversion rate fell from 40% to 32%: eight percentage points, or a 20% relative decline from the original rate. These are two descriptions of the same change, not interchangeable units.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### device segment

A group of users or sessions using a specified device type.

**IN USE analyze a device segment**

### payment failure

An unsuccessful payment attempt under the relevant process.

**IN USE investigate payment failures**

### payment gateway

A service connecting a checkout to payment processing.

**IN USE monitor the payment gateway**

### provider outage

A disruption to a third-party service.

**IN USE isolate the provider outage**

### confounder

A factor that complicates a causal interpretation.

**IN USE identify a confounder**

### causal attribution

Assigning an observed outcome to its cause.

**IN USE qualify causal attribution**

### controlled experiment

A comparison designed to isolate an intervention's effect.

**IN USE run a controlled experiment**

### random assignment

Allocation by chance to comparison groups.

**IN USE verify random assignment**

### cohort

A group sharing a defined characteristic or starting event.

**IN USE define a cohort**

### user experience (UX)

A person's experience of interacting with a product or service.

**IN USE assess the user experience**

### friction

An obstacle making a customer action harder.

**IN USE reduce checkout friction**

### rollback

Returning a change to an earlier version.

**IN USE evaluate a rollback**

### Precision check

This metric counts sessions completing a purchase, not purchase events or purchased items. A session can contain multiple events. Verify collection, deduplication, eligibility, device mix, and outage exposure before attributing the change.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 1 of 2

### STATE THE OBSERVED RESULT

"Checkout conversion fell from forty to thirty-two percent."

### GIVE THE RELATIVE COMPARISON

"Relative to the original rate, the decline is twenty percent."

### PROTECT THE DENOMINATOR

"Both periods contain one thousand eligible checkout sessions."

### LIMIT CAUSALITY

"This comparison does not isolate the redesign's effect."

### USE THE CORRECT ABSOLUTE UNIT

"That is a decline of eight percentage points."

### DEFINE THE COUNTED OUTCOME

"We count a session once if it completes a purchase."

### NAME THE COMPETING EVENT

"A payment-provider outage overlapped the later period."

### REQUEST A MEASUREMENT CHECK

"Has event collection remained consistent across the release?"

---

### Fell from ... to ...

Makes both rates explicit before discussing their difference.

### Percentage points

Measures the absolute distance between two percentage rates.

### Relative to

Identifies the initial value used for relative change.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 2 of 2

### SEPARATE EVENTS AND SESSIONS

"More purchase events do not necessarily mean more purchasing sessions."

### INVESTIGATE THE OUTAGE

"Separate affected and unaffected time intervals."

### RECOGNIZE THE BUSINESS PROBLEM

"Uncertain attribution does not make the decline unimportant."

### KEEP A DECISION CONDITIONAL

"A rollback decision should use the full risk and performance evidence."

### CHECK COMPOSITION

"Compare traffic and device mix before interpreting the aggregate."

### AVOID A NEW OVERCLAIM

"That breakdown would be informative, not automatically causal."

### DEFINE A NEXT ANALYSIS

"Validate the data, then compare the relevant segments."

### SUMMARIZE THE FINDING

"We have a measured decline and an unresolved explanation."

---

### Overlapped

Shows co-occurrence without claiming a complete explanation.

### Does not isolate

Limits causal inference, not the existence of the observed result.

### Not automatically

Prevents a useful diagnostic from becoming an unsupported proof.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which sentence uses the correct units?

- A** Conversion fell eight percent relative and twenty percentage points.
- B** Conversion fell thirty-two percentage points.
- C** Conversion rose because session counts were unchanged.
- D** Conversion fell eight percentage points, a twenty-percent relative decline.

### 2. Which denominator belongs in this report?

- A** Purchased items
- B** All recorded purchase events
- C** Only sessions that purchased
- D** Eligible checkout sessions

### 3. Which statement overclaims causality?

- A** The redesign caused the entire decline.
- B** The decline coincided with a provider outage.
- C** Measurement consistency needs checking.
- D** The later rate was thirty-two percent.

### 4. Which diagnostic is useful but not automatically causal proof?

- A** Count duplicate events as separate successful sessions.
- B** Compare outage-affected intervals with unaffected intervals while checking their differences.
- C** Assume all missing purchases were outage-related.
- D** Ignore device mix because totals match.

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

# A checkout decline with two competing explanations

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

device segment / event instrumentation / traffic mix / checkout conversion / denominator / percentage points / deduplication / causal attribution / provider outage / rollback

- 01 **Mara:** The weekly dashboard says checkout dropped after the redesign. The team is asking whether we should reverse the release immediately.
- 02 **Dev:** The <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ rate did fall, from forty to thirty-two percent. We should acknowledge that result, but the before-and-after chart alone does not identify the cause.
- 03 **Mara:** I wrote an eight-percent decline in my draft. Is that the clearest description?
- 04 **Dev:** Use eight <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ for the absolute change. The relative decline is twenty percent because we divide the eight-point difference by the original forty-percent rate.
- 05 **Mara:** Both periods had one thousand checkout sessions. Does that make the comparison fully controlled?
- 06 **Dev:** No. A common <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ count does not make the visitors or conditions identical. We still need to verify eligibility, measurement, and the composition of the sessions.
- 07 **Mara:** The payment provider was down during part of the later period. That seems important.
- 08 **Dev:** The <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is a competing explanation we must investigate. We cannot ignore it, but we also cannot assume it accounts for every missing purchase.
- 09 **Mara:** Can we compare the affected hours with the unaffected hours?
- 10 **Dev:** Yes, while checking <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Those intervals may attract different visitors. The breakdown can identify patterns, but it is not automatically a controlled estimate of the redesign's effect.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Mara:** The developers changed some analytics code during the release. Could that affect the result?
- 12 **Dev:** We should audit <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Confirm that checkout entry and completion are captured consistently. Otherwise an apparent behavior change may include a measurement change.
- 13 **Mara:** The purchase-event count is higher than the number of purchasing sessions. Is the dashboard necessarily wrong?
- 14 **Dev:** Not necessarily. Check <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and the metric definition. This report counts each eligible purchasing session at most once, not every purchase event or every item purchased.
- 15 **Mara:** So the same session could produce several recorded events without becoming several successful sessions.
- 16 **Dev:** Exactly. Then examine each relevant <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. A mobile-specific issue would be useful to locate, but we should not invent one before seeing the breakdown.
- 17 **Mara:** The team still needs a release decision. I do not want uncertainty to become an excuse for doing nothing.
- 18 **Dev:** Agreed. Evaluate a <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ alongside the actual risks and diagnostics. My caution concerns the explanation, not whether the decline deserves urgent attention.
- 19 **Mara:** I will report the two rates, the outage, and the checks we are doing before claiming a cause.
- 20 **Dev:** That keeps <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ honest. We have a real reported decline, several testable questions, and a clear next analysis. That is more useful than blaming the release from one chart.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. checkout conversion | 2. percentage points | 3. denominator | 4. provider outage | 5. traffic mix | 6. event instrumentation | 7. deduplication | 8. device segment | 9. rollback | 10. causal attribution

# Explain a second conversion comparison

## F Say it

A fixed report counts 300 purchasing sessions out of 600 eligible sessions before a change and 240 out of 600 afterward. One session counts at most once.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

20% / 40% / ten percentage points / 50%

Lead: "The original rate was <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Analyst: "The later rate was <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Lead: "The absolute decline was <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Analyst: "The relative decline was <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. 50% | 2. 40% | 3. ten percentage points | 4. 20%

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# The supplier with more defects has the lower rate

## A Read the situation

**Challenge a vendor scorecard by specifying the unit, denominator, period, and comparison limits.**

06

A July scorecard shows Vendor K with ten defective units and Vendor M with five. The heading says K has the higher defect rate. Receiving records show 800 units received from K and 200 from M in July. Count each defective unit once, even if it has several faults; all counts refer to these July receipts. Product mix and inspection intensity have not been confirmed as comparable. Vendor manager Rosa and supplier representative Malik must correct the rate comparison before discussing causes or commercial deductions.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Vendor manager | Malik: Supplier representative

### MAKE THE DISPUTED NUMBER REPRODUCIBLE

Supplier discussions can become adversarial when a scorecard is treated as unquestionable. Ask for the counted unit and denominator, then do the calculation together. Correcting a ranking does not excuse the underlying defects or establish which party caused them.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Vendor K's defective-unit rate?

- A 10%
- C 2.5%

- B 5%
- D 1.25%

2. What is Vendor M's defective-unit rate?

- A 5%
- C 2.5%

- B 0.625%
- D 1.25%

3. What remains unverified?

- A K's July received count
- C The stated counting rule

- B M's July defective-unit count
- D Comparable product mix and inspection intensity

Answers and explanations: page 86.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### vendor scorecard

A report comparing supplier performance against defined measures.

**IN USE** correct a vendor scorecard

### defective-unit rate

Defective units divided by the specified unit population.

**IN USE** calculate the defective-unit rate

### defect count

The number of individual faults identified.

**IN USE** distinguish the defect count

### received units

Units recorded as received within the defined scope.

**IN USE** confirm received units

### inspection intensity

The extent or frequency of examination.

**IN USE** compare inspection intensity

### product mix

The composition of products within a measured group.

**IN USE** control for product mix

### reporting period

The time interval covered by a measure.

**IN USE** specify the reporting period

### purchase order

A buyer's formal order specifying the relevant purchase terms.

**IN USE** reconcile the purchase order

### vendor allowance

A supplier-funded amount under agreed commercial terms.

**IN USE** verify a vendor allowance

### chargeback

A commercial deduction or charge asserted under applicable terms.

**IN USE** dispute a vendor chargeback

### supplier corrective action

An action addressing an established supplier-related problem.

**IN USE** request supplier corrective action

### root cause

The underlying reason for a problem, supported by investigation.

**IN USE** establish the root cause

### Precision check

A count is not a rate. K has more defective units but a lower defective-unit rate:  $10/800 = 1.25\%$ , compared with M at  $5/200 = 2.5\%$ . Each defective unit is counted only once.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### acceptance criterion

A requirement used to determine whether goods meet expectations.

**IN USE confirm the acceptance criterion**

### inspection record

Evidence of what was examined and found.

**IN USE retrieve the inspection record**

### sample size

The number of units examined in a sample.

**IN USE state the sample size**

### lot

A defined group of goods identified for traceability.

**IN USE trace the affected lot**

### return to vendor

Sending goods back to the supplying party.

**IN USE authorize a return to vendor**

### marketplace listing

A product offer displayed on a marketplace.

**IN USE update the marketplace listing**

### seller of record

The party identified as the seller for the transaction.

**IN USE identify the seller of record**

### catalog attribute

A structured product detail such as size or material.

**IN USE correct a catalog attribute**

### content compliance

Conformity with applicable product-content requirements.

**IN USE review content compliance**

### service-level agreement

Terms defining expected service performance and responsibilities.

**IN USE review the service-level agreement**

### dispute evidence

Records supporting a challenge to a claim or deduction.

**IN USE submit dispute evidence**

### remediation plan

A defined set of actions to address a problem.

**IN USE agree a remediation plan**

### Precision check

A lower observed rate does not prove better inherent quality when inspection and product mix differ. The scorecard does not itself establish root cause, supplier liability, or the right to a commercial deduction.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 1 of 2

### ASK FOR THE BASE

"What received-unit denominator is behind this rate?"

### CLARIFY THE COUNTED OBJECT

"Count each defective unit once, not every fault separately."

### SHOW THE CALCULATION

"Ten divided by eight hundred gives 1.25%."

### KEEP DEFECTS VISIBLE

"Correcting the ranking does not remove the ten defective units."

### STATE THE PERIOD

"Both figures refer to July receipts."

### CORRECT THE LABEL

"Ten is a count, not a percentage."

### COMPARE ACCURATELY

"K has the larger count but the lower observed rate."

### CHECK COMPARABILITY

"Were product mix and inspection intensity comparable?"

06

---

### Observed rate

Restricts the comparison to recorded data, not inherent supplier quality.

### Count each ... once

Defines the unit and prevents double-counting multiple faults.

### Behind this rate

Requests the denominator supporting the displayed percentage.

# Phrases you can actually use

## C Notice the language / 2 of 2

### REQUEST TRACEABLE EVIDENCE

"Please link the findings to the relevant lots and inspection records."

### SEPARATE COMMERCIAL AUTHORITY

"A scorecard result does not automatically authorize a deduction."

### KEEP THE CHALLENGE CONSTRUCTIVE

"I am challenging the rate label, not dismissing the reported defects."

### DEFINE THE FOLLOW-UP

"Review the defect evidence and the comparison basis separately."

### AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED CAUSE

"These numbers do not establish how the damage occurred."

### CHECK THE TERMS

"We need the applicable agreement before deciding any chargeback."

### AGREE A CORRECTION

"Let us republish the rates with their denominators."

### CLOSE THE DISPUTE PRECISELY

"The arithmetic is corrected; the cause and commercial outcome remain open."

06

---

### Not dismissing

Preserves the substantive concern while challenging its description.

### Automatically

Flags an unsupported leap from a metric to an entitlement.

### Remain open

Keeps unresolved questions distinct from the corrected arithmetic.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

### 1. Which ranking is arithmetically correct?

- A** K has a higher rate because ten exceeds five.
- B** Both rates are equal because both have defects.
- C** M's rate is five percent regardless of receipts.
- D** K has a lower defective-unit rate than M.

### 2. If one unit has three faults, how is it counted here?

- A** As three received units
- B** As no defective units
- C** As one defective unit
- D** As three defective units

### 3. Which claim still needs investigation?

- A** K has better inherent quality under comparable conditions.
- B** K received 800 units in July.
- C** M had five defective units.
- D** K's observed rate is 1.25%.

### 4. Which action is not authorized merely by the scorecard?

- A** Requesting inspection records
- B** Deducting a chargeback from the supplier's invoice
- C** Correcting the rate arithmetic
- D** Stating the received-unit counts

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

# The supplier with more defects has the lower rate

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

defective-unit rate / product mix / received units / vendor scorecard / reporting period / root cause / defect count / inspection record / chargeback / remediation plan

- 01 **Rosa:** The July scorecard says your defect rate is higher than Vendor M's. We recorded ten defective units from you and five from them.
- 02 **Malik:** Could we check the <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ behind those figures? I am not disputing the ten reported units, but the heading compares rates while the table only shows counts.
- 03 **Rosa:** The receiving file has eight hundred units from K and two hundred from M.
- 04 **Malik:** Then our <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is one point two five percent, while M's is two point five percent. The larger defect count does not make our rate higher.
- 05 **Rosa:** You are right about the calculation. We should correct that before it goes into the supplier review.
- 06 **Malik:** Please also state the <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. I understand these counts all refer to July receipts. A rate could still be misleading if the defects came from a different receipt period.
- 07 **Rosa:** They all relate to July. Some units had several faults; the inspection team counted each affected unit once.
- 08 **Malik:** Good. That distinguishes defective units from <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. We should preserve that rule in the scorecard so next month's calculation does not silently change.
- 09 **Rosa:** Does the lower rate mean K has better quality overall?
- 10 **Malik:** It is a lower observed rate, but we need to compare <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and inspection intensity before making that broader claim. I would not use the corrected arithmetic to dismiss the ten units.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Rosa:** The inspection details should tell us what failed and how the goods were examined.
- 12 **Malik:** Please share the relevant <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ through the agreed channel. We can review the lot references and acceptance criteria rather than argue over an unexplained total.
- 13 **Rosa:** Operations suspects the packaging caused the damage, but the report has not established that.
- 14 **Malik:** Then packaging is a hypothesis, not a confirmed <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. We should examine the evidence and handling history before assigning responsibility. A useful correction depends on identifying the actual problem.
- 15 **Rosa:** The commercial team also wants to deduct a fee from your next invoice.
- 16 **Malik:** Any <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ needs the applicable terms and evidence. Correcting the rate does not decide that question, and the original heading does not automatically establish a right to deduct.
- 17 **Rosa:** I will separate the metric correction from the quality investigation and the commercial discussion.
- 18 **Malik:** That works. We can agree a <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ when the findings support the actions. Let us not promise a packaging change merely to close the meeting.
- 19 **Rosa:** I will republish both denominators, the July period, and the corrected percentages. The ten affected units will remain visible.
- 20 **Malik:** Thank you. The revised <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ will then support a fair discussion. We can acknowledge the quality concern while keeping the arithmetic, causal investigation, and contract issues distinct.

06

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. received units | 2. defective-unit rate | 3. reporting period | 4. defect count | 5. product mix | 6. inspection record | 7. root cause | 8. chargeback | 9. remediation plan | 10. vendor scorecard

# Correct a second supplier ranking

## F Say it

For the same month, Vendor P has six defective units among 600 received; Vendor Q has four among 200. Count each defective unit once.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

Q / 1% / 2% / P

Manager: "P's defective-unit rate is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Supplier: "Q's defective-unit rate is <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Manager: "The larger defective-unit count belongs to <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Supplier: "The higher defective-unit rate belongs to <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. 1% | 2. 2% | 3. P | 4. Q

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# A return request beyond the goodwill window

## A Read the situation

**Acknowledge a customer request, explain a bounded exception review, and distinguish policy from applicable rights.**

Customer Owen wants to return an unworn \$80 jacket because he changed his mind. His request is on day 35; the retailer states a 30-day change-of-mind return window for this purchase. No fault or misdescription is alleged. Agent Elena cannot approve a goodwill exception but can submit a review to the store manager. No review outcome is supplied. Before treating the policy as decisive, the team must check any applicable customer rights and transaction facts. A fault complaint would require a different assessment, not an automatic rejection under the goodwill window.

PEOPLE / Owen: Customer | Elena: Service representative

07

### EMPATHY IS NOT AN APPROVAL FORMULA

An apologetic tone can accidentally sound like a refund commitment. Acknowledge the inconvenience, then state exactly what can happen next. Avoid describing a customer as difficult merely because the requested remedy is outside your authority.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Why does Owen want to return the jacket?

- A A recall notice requires its return.
- C The jacket is alleged to be faulty.

- B He changed his mind.
- D The wrong product was delivered.

2. What can Elena authorize herself?

- A A guaranteed exchange
- C Submission of a manager review, not approval of the exception

- B A binding extension of every return window
- D An immediate \$80 refund

3. How should the 30-day policy be treated?

- A As a universal legal limit for every transaction
- C As proof the jacket is defective

- B As irrelevant to any review
- D As a stated policy that does not override applicable rights

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### change-of-mind return

A return requested because the customer no longer wants the item.

**IN USE** handle a change-of-mind return

### return window

The period specified for a return under particular terms.

**IN USE** check the return window

### goodwill exception

A discretionary departure from policy where permitted.

**IN USE** request a goodwill exception

### exception authority

The defined power to approve a policy departure.

**IN USE** confirm exception authority

### proof of purchase

Evidence identifying a purchase and its relevant details.

**IN USE** verify proof of purchase

### purchase channel

The route through which the customer bought the item.

**IN USE** identify the purchase channel

### item condition

The physical state of a product.

**IN USE** assess item condition

### original payment method

The payment route used for the original purchase.

**IN USE** verify the original payment method

### store credit

Value available for a future purchase from the retailer.

**IN USE** explain store credit

### exchange

Replacing a purchased item with another under relevant terms.

**IN USE** authorize an exchange

### refund

Return of an amount paid.

**IN USE** confirm a refund

### manager review

Assessment by the person assigned the relevant decision authority.

**IN USE** submit a manager review

### Precision check

This is a change-of-mind request on day 35, not an established fault claim. Record the actual reason accurately. The 30-day policy is a fictional retailer rule for this purchase, not a universal statement of consumer law.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### fault allegation

A customer's statement that a product has a defect.

**IN USE** record a fault allegation

### misdescription

A mismatch between an item and its stated description.

**IN USE** investigate misdescription

### applicable rights

Customer protections relevant to the actual transaction.

**IN USE** check applicable rights

### statutory remedy

A remedy arising under the relevant law.

**IN USE** distinguish a statutory remedy

### policy discretion

Permitted choice within an organization's policy authority.

**IN USE** explain policy discretion

### escalation route

The defined path to a higher or specialist review.

**IN USE** offer an escalation route

### complaint record

A documented account of a customer's concern and its handling.

**IN USE** maintain a complaint record

### case owner

The person responsible for coordinating the case.

**IN USE** identify the case owner

### review outcome

The result of an assessment.

**IN USE** communicate the review outcome

### reason code

A structured label describing the basis for a transaction or request.

**IN USE** select the correct reason code

### resolution option

A possible way to address the customer's concern.

**IN USE** verify resolution options

### service handoff

Transfer of relevant context and responsibility to another team member.

**IN USE** complete a service handoff

### Precision check

Submitting a review does not approve a refund, exchange, or store credit. Applicable rights must be checked separately; a retailer cannot replace a required remedy with discretionary goodwill merely by changing the label.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 1 of 2

### ACKNOWLEDGE THE REQUEST

"You would like to return the unworn jacket because you changed your mind."

### STATE THE POLICY CAREFULLY

"The stated change-of-mind window for this purchase is thirty days."

### EXPLAIN YOUR AUTHORITY

"I can submit the request, but I cannot approve an exception myself."

### AVOID A GUARANTEED OUTCOME

"Submission does not guarantee a refund or exchange."

### IDENTIFY THE TIMING

"This request is on day thirty-five."

### KEEP RIGHTS SEPARATE

"We also need to check the rights applicable to the actual transaction."

### OFFER THE REAL NEXT STEP

"I can refer this to the store manager for review."

### REQUEST RELEVANT EVIDENCE

"Please provide the purchase details through our approved process."

---

### For this purchase

Limits a policy statement to its actual transaction context.

### I can ... but I cannot

Separates a permitted action from an unheld authority.

### Would you like

Seeks the customer's choice about the offered review.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

### **RESPECT THE CUSTOMER'S CHOICE**

"Would you like me to submit that review?"

### **DISTINGUISH A NEW ALLEGATION**

"If you are reporting a fault, I need to record and assess that separately."

### **REDUCE REPETITION**

"I will include the details you have already supplied."

### **KEEP THE HANDOFF USEFUL**

"The record will show the timing, reason, item condition, and requested remedy."

### **RECORD THE CORRECT REASON**

"I will record this as a change-of-mind request."

### **AVOID AN INVENTED SUBSTITUTE**

"Store credit has not been approved either."

### **NAME THE DECISION-MAKER**

"The manager holds the stated exception authority."

### **CLOSE HONESTLY**

"I will communicate the actual review outcome without promising it in advance."

---

### **Has not been approved**

Prevents an alternative remedy from being implied as available.

### **If you are reporting**

Distinguishes a new factual allegation requiring a different assessment.

### **Without promising**

Preserves a clear process commitment while leaving the decision open.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which sentence stays within Elena's authority?

- A** I have extended the policy for every customer.
- B** I can submit a manager review, but I cannot guarantee its outcome.
- C** I can guarantee the manager will approve this.
- D** Store credit is automatically yours because a refund is unavailable.

### 2. Which record best matches the stated request?

- A** Misdescription established; exchange mandatory
- B** Customer withdrew the request
- C** Change of mind; unworn jacket; day 35; \$80 purchase
- D** Confirmed product defect; refund approved

### 3. Which response to a newly alleged fault is appropriate?

- A** Promise a refund before checking any facts.
- B** Record the allegation and assess the applicable rights and process separately.
- C** Reject it automatically because the goodwill window ended.
- D** Change the label to avoid an investigation.

### 4. Which phrase asks permission without implying approval?

- A** The manager has accepted the request.
- B** Your exception is guaranteed.
- C** Would you like me to submit the review?
- D** Your refund is being processed.

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

# A return request beyond the goodwill window

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

change-of-mind return / manager review / return window / fault allegation / exception authority / goodwill exception / proof of purchase / complaint record / service handoff / store credit

07

- 01 **Owen:** I bought this jacket for eighty dollars and have not worn it. I changed my mind, but I see I am five days beyond the return period.
- 02 **Elena:** You are asking for a <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ on day thirty-five. I understand you would prefer not to keep an unworn item. Let me explain what I can do without promising a decision I cannot make.
- 03 **Owen:** The receipt says thirty days. Is there any way to ask someone to look at it?
- 04 **Elena:** Yes. The stated <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is thirty days for this purchase. We also need to check the actual transaction and applicable rights rather than treat that policy as a universal legal answer.
- 05 **Owen:** I am not saying there is anything wrong with it. I simply chose the wrong style for myself.
- 06 **Elena:** I will record that accurately. I can request a <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_, but I cannot approve one myself. The store manager can assess the request under the relevant process.
- 07 **Owen:** If you send it to the manager, does that mean I will get the money back?
- 08 **Elena:** No. A <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is a request for a decision, not the decision itself. I do not want you to hear a refund promise when I am offering a review.
- 09 **Owen:** Would store credit be easier? I would be willing to buy something else here.
- 10 **Elena:** I can include that preference, but <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ has not been approved either. I should not present it as an automatic substitute simply because the original request is outside the stated window.

# The conversation, continued

## E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Owen:** All right. What information does the manager need from me?
- 12 **Elena:** We need the relevant <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_, the item condition, and your requested remedy through the approved process. I will include what you have already told me so you do not have to start again.
- 13 **Owen:** I have the receipt and the jacket with its tags. Please submit the request.
- 14 **Elena:** I will. The manager has the <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ described in our process. I will keep your reason and preferred outcomes clear rather than suggest the jacket is faulty to make the request sound stronger.
- 15 **Owen:** Suppose I later notice a fault. Would the thirty-day window automatically rule that out too?
- 16 **Elena:** A <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ would need to be recorded and assessed separately under the applicable rights and facts. I cannot decide that hypothetical claim from the change-of-mind policy alone.
- 17 **Owen:** That is clear. For now, it is just the style, and I would like the review.
- 18 **Elena:** The <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ will show the eighty-dollar jacket, unworn condition, day thirty-five, and your preference. It will not say a refund or exchange has already been agreed.
- 19 **Owen:** Please make sure whoever responds knows that I was offered a review, not a guaranteed exception.
- 20 **Elena:** I will preserve that in the <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. The next response should communicate the actual assessment and explain the available next step, not make you reconstruct this conversation.

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. change-of-mind return | 2. return window | 3. goodwill exception | 4. manager review | 5. store credit | 6. proof of purchase | 7. exception authority | 8. fault allegation | 9. complaint record | 10. service handoff

# Keep another review within its authority

## F Say it

A customer requests a change-of-mind return on day 22 under a stated 14-day policy. Agent Noor may submit a review to manager Beth but cannot approve it. No outcome is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

14 / 22 / approval / Beth

Noor: "The request is on day <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Customer: "The stated policy window is <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ days."

Noor: "The manager reviewing the request is <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Customer: "Submission does not guarantee <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. 22 | 2. 14 | 3. Beth | 4. approval

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf

## A Read the situation

**Give an actionable shift handoff that corrects a false pickup status without hiding the missing item.**

At 16:00, pickup order P64 shows ready online. It contains three items: a notebook, a pen set, and a mug. Staff have located and staged the notebook and pen set, but cannot find the mug. No substitute has been approved. Outgoing lead Talia must hand the issue to incoming lead Evan, who will contact the customer and update the case at 16:30. The local process requires every ordered item to be verified and staged before the whole order is marked ready. Partial pickup needs the permitted process and the customer's agreement.

PEOPLE / Talia: Outgoing shift lead | Evan: Incoming shift lead

08

### HANDOVER LANGUAGE MUST SUPPORT THE NEXT ACTION

A cheerful all sorted can conceal an unfinished customer problem. Name the item, the physical status, the system discrepancy, and the next owner. The incoming colleague needs enough detail to act without repeating the search or misleading the customer.

## Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which item has not been located?

A The mug

B The notebook

C The pen set

D All three items

2. What does the local whole-order ready status require?

A A shift handoff completed

B Every ordered item verified and staged

C Any one item scanned

D A label printed

3. Who owns the next customer contact?

A The customer

B Evan

C Talia after she leaves

D An unnamed carrier

Answers and explanations: page 90.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### omnichannel

Coordinated retail activity across store and digital channels.

**IN USE** coordinate omnichannel execution

### buy online, pick up in store (BOPIS)

Ordering online for collection at a store.

**IN USE** fulfill a BOPIS order

### click and collect

An online order collected from a designated location.

**IN USE** manage click-and-collect orders

### order management system (OMS)

Software coordinating order information and fulfillment status.

**IN USE** update the OMS

### point of sale (POS)

The system or place where a retail sale is processed.

**IN USE** reconcile POS records

### picking

Retrieving the specified items for an order.

**IN USE** complete order picking

### pick list

A list of items and quantities to retrieve.

**IN USE** verify the pick list

### staging

Placing picked items in the designated holding area.

**IN USE** confirm order staging

### pickup shelf

The area holding orders prepared for collection.

**IN USE** check the pickup shelf

### ready-for-pickup status

A status indicating the specified readiness conditions are met.

**IN USE** correct ready-for-pickup status

### short pick

A pick in which the required quantity cannot be found or supplied.

**IN USE** record a short pick

### item-level status

The state recorded for an individual order item.

**IN USE** update item-level status

08

### Precision check

Two staged items do not make this three-item order ready under the stated local process. A missing mug is not evidence that it was collected, canceled, or refunded. Keep each status tied to its actual event.

# The vocabulary that does the work

## **B** Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

### **order-level status**

The overall state recorded for the complete order.

**IN USE** correct order-level status

### **substitution**

Supplying a different item in place of the ordered one.

**IN USE** confirm a substitution

### **customer consent**

The customer's agreement to a proposed action.

**IN USE** obtain customer consent

### **partial pickup**

Collection of only part of the ordered items.

**IN USE** arrange partial pickup

### **pickup notification**

A message telling the customer about collection readiness.

**IN USE** correct a pickup notification

### **collection verification**

Checking the required identity or order details at pickup.

**IN USE** complete collection verification

### **cancellation line**

An order item recorded for cancellation under the process.

**IN USE** confirm a cancellation line

### **refund status**

The actual stage of returning the relevant payment.

**IN USE** verify refund status

### **shift handoff**

Transfer of work status and responsibility between shifts.

**IN USE** give a shift handoff

### **action owner**

The person responsible for a specified next action.

**IN USE** name the action owner

### **discrepancy log**

A record of mismatches requiring follow-up.

**IN USE** update the discrepancy log

### **resolution checkpoint**

A scheduled point to review progress on an open issue.

**IN USE** set a resolution checkpoint

08

### **Precision check**

Partial pickup and substitution are different options. Neither should be assumed from silence or staff convenience. Use the permitted process, obtain the necessary customer agreement, and preserve the remaining item and payment status.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 1 of 2

### START WITH THE ORDER

"This handoff concerns pickup order P64."

### NAME THE GAP

"The mug has not been found."

### APPLY THE LOCAL RULE

"Whole-order readiness requires all three items to be verified and staged."

### PROTECT THE REMAINING ITEMS

"Keep the two staged items identified with this order."

### STATE THE VERIFIED ITEMS

"The notebook and pen set are located and staged."

### IDENTIFY THE CONTRADICTION

"The website says ready, but the order is incomplete."

### CORRECT THE VISIBLE STATUS

"We need to correct the ready message through the approved process."

### REJECT AN ASSUMED SUBSTITUTE

"No substitute has been approved."

08

---

### Located and staged

Describes physical preparation, not simply a system entry.

### Has not been found

States the search result without inventing theft or cancellation.

### Through the approved process

Makes the correction traceable and properly authorized.

# Phrases you can actually use

## **C** Notice the language / 2 of 2

### OFFER A BOUNDED CHOICE

"Check whether partial pickup is permitted and whether the customer agrees."

### SET THE CHECKPOINT

"Update the case at 16:30."

### KEEP MONEY STATUS SEPARATE

"Do not mark a refund complete unless it has actually reached that status."

### PRESERVE THE OPEN ITEM

"The mug remains unresolved until its actual disposition is recorded."

### ASSIGN THE NEXT ACTION

"Evan will contact the customer."

### LIMIT THE PROMISE

"That is a review time, not a promise that the mug will be found."

### REDUCE REPEATED WORK

"Record which locations have already been checked."

### CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"Confirm the owner, customer message, and outstanding item before leaving."

08

---

### Whether ... and whether ...

Separates process permission from customer agreement.

### Not a promise

Keeps a scheduled checkpoint from becoming a guaranteed result.

### Actual disposition

Refers to what truly happened to the missing order line.

# Choose the precise message

## **D** Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

### 1. Which handoff is actionable?

- A** P64 is sorted; the next shift can check later.
- B** All items are ready because the website says so.
- C** The mug must have been collected because it is absent.
- D** P64: two items staged, mug missing, ready status incorrect; Evan contacts customer and updates at 16:30.

### 2. Which substitution claim is supported?

- A** The pen set replaces the mug automatically.
- B** Silence from the customer confirms a substitution.
- C** No substitute has been approved.
- D** Any similar mug may be supplied without agreement.

### 3. What does 16:30 mean?

- A** Automatic cancellation of the whole order
- B** A case-update checkpoint
- C** Guaranteed completion of the missing-item search
- D** A confirmed refund completion time

### 4. Which record would invent an event?

- A** Marking the missing mug as collected because staff cannot find it
- B** Keeping the mug unresolved
- C** Recording the two staged items
- D** Correcting the unsupported ready message

Answers and explanations: page 90.

# Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf

## E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

resolution checkpoint / action owner / partial pickup / short pick / pickup notification / substitution / refund status / order-level status / staging / discrepancy log

08

- 01 **Talia:** Before I leave, P64 needs your attention. It is marked ready online, but we have only the notebook and pen set on the pickup shelf.
- 02 **Evan:** Then the <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ does not match the physical position. Which item is missing, and have we confirmed the other two belong to this order?
- 03 **Talia:** The mug has not been found. The notebook and pen set are identified for P64 and are already in the designated holding area.
- 04 **Evan:** Keep that <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ information in the handoff. We should protect those items while we investigate the mug, not return them to general stock without a proper reason.
- 05 **Talia:** The online message may already have encouraged the customer to come in. We need to correct that before they make an unnecessary journey.
- 06 **Evan:** I will address the <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ and contact the customer. Our local process requires all three items to be verified and staged before the entire order is ready.
- 07 **Talia:** Could we tell them to collect the two items while we continue the search?
- 08 **Evan:** We can check whether <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is permitted and ask whether that works for them. We should not assume they want two trips or silently treat the missing line as complete.
- 09 **Talia:** There is a different mug on the display nearby. No one has asked the customer about that option.
- 10 **Evan:** Then there is no approved <sup>5</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. Similar appearance is not enough. The customer may have chosen the specific size or design for a reason.

# The conversation, continued

## **E** Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Talia:** I will list the locations already checked so your team does not repeat the same search.
- 12 **Evan:** Good. Record the <sup>6</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ against the mug and preserve the actual item details. Do not infer theft, collection, or cancellation simply because we cannot find it.
- 13 **Talia:** You will own the customer contact after the shift change. Shall we set a review at half past four?
- 14 **Evan:** Yes. I am the <sup>7</sup> \_\_\_\_\_, and I will update the case at sixteen thirty. That gives the team a clear next contact without promising the mug will be found by then.
- 15 **Talia:** If the customer asks to cancel the missing item, we should follow the actual cancellation and payment process.
- 16 **Evan:** Correct. Keep <sup>8</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ separate from the request. We must not tell the customer money has been returned before that is supported by the relevant record.
- 17 **Talia:** I will leave P64 open with two staged items, the missing mug, the incorrect ready message, and the search history.
- 18 **Evan:** Add those points to the <sup>9</sup> \_\_\_\_\_. I will correct the customer-facing position through the approved process and make the offered options explicit when we speak.
- 19 **Talia:** That is everything from my side. Please confirm that you have the order details and the scheduled update.
- 20 **Evan:** Confirmed. The <sup>10</sup> \_\_\_\_\_ is sixteen thirty, and the mug remains unresolved. I will carry the customer contact and record the actual next decision instead of allowing the ready label to stand.

08

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. order-level status | 2. staging | 3. pickup notification | 4. partial pickup | 5. substitution | 6. short pick | 7. action owner | 8. refund status | 9. discrepancy log | 10. resolution checkpoint

# Give a second pickup handoff

## F Say it

Order C17 contains four items. Three are staged; a desk lamp is missing. Incoming lead Jun owns the next customer contact and will update the case at 18:00. No substitute is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

### WORD + PHRASE BANK

desk lamp / C17 / Jun / 18:00

08

Outgoing lead: "The order reference is <sup>1</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Jun: "The missing item is the <sup>2</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Outgoing lead: "The next contact owner is <sup>3</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

Jun: "The next case update is at <sup>4</sup> \_\_\_\_\_."

### ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. C17 | 2. desk lamp | 3. Jun | 4. 18:00

## Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

### WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

# 01 Briefing and language checks

## Merchandising and Assortment Planning

### A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is Range A's sell-through under the stated definition?

**D. 80%**

Eighty units sold divided by one hundred opening units equals eighty percent.

2. How many units remain in Range B?

**A. 80**

Two hundred opening units minus one hundred twenty sold leaves eighty units.

3. What is not yet established?

**C. Which range has higher gross profit**

Product costs are missing, so equal revenue does not establish relative gross profit.

### D Language checks / page 9

1. Which comparison is accurate?

**A. A sold 80% of opening units; B sold 60%.**

Each range needs its own opening-unit denominator; revenue does not replace that stock base.

2. Which claim needs product costs?

**B. A earned more gross profit than B.**

Gross profit subtracts product costs, which the briefing does not supply.

3. Which recommendation is appropriately limited?

**C. Review B by variant and customer segment before changing the buy.**

Variant and segment evidence supports a more specific decision than the aggregate result alone.

4. Which wording states a condition?

**B. We can revise the buy once the cost and variant review is complete.**

Once makes the proposed action depend on completing the specified review.

# 01 Conversation answers

## Merchandising and Assortment Planning

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

**1. sell-through.** Turn 2. Sell-through compares sold units with the defined stock base, revealing a difference that equal revenue hides.

**2. residual stock.** Turn 4. Residual stock is the inventory left after sales; B retains eighty units while A retains twenty.

**3. markdown.** Turn 6. Markdown names the price reduction used to support B's sales, not the sales volume itself.

**4. delisting.** Turn 8. Delisting removes a product from the active range; the evidence does not yet justify removing all of B.

**5. size curve.** Turn 10. The size curve describes the unit distribution across sizes, which may explain uneven leftover stock.

**6. customer segment.** Turn 12. Customer segment identifies the group served by a range and helps assess its distinct commercial role.

**7. buying budget.** Turn 14. Buying budget names the money allocated to merchandise purchases, constraining the proposed initial order.

**8. gross margin return on inventory.** Turn 16. This measure relates gross profit to average inventory cost, requiring cost and investment information absent here.

**9. range review.** Turn 18. Range review is the structured assessment bringing together sales, stock, pricing, and the role of the selection.

**10. assortment depth.** Turn 20. Assortment depth concerns how much is held within selected lines, distinct from removing the entire range.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 12

#### 1. 75%

Buyer: "C has a sell-through rate of 75%."

Forty-five sold units divided by sixty opening units equals seventy-five percent.

#### 2. 50%

Planner: "D has a sell-through rate of 50%."

Sixty sold units divided by one hundred twenty opening units equals fifty percent.

#### 3. 15

Buyer: "C has 15 units remaining."

Sixty opening units less forty-five sold leaves fifteen remaining units.

#### 4. 60

Planner: "D has 60 units remaining."

One hundred twenty opening units less sixty sold leaves sixty remaining units.

## 02 Briefing and language checks

### Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

#### A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What was promotion revenue?

**A. \$5,100**

One hundred twenty units multiplied by forty-two dollars fifty equals five thousand one hundred dollars.

2. What was promotion gross profit on the stated basis?

**C. \$1,500**

Revenue of \$5,100 less product costs of \$3,600 leaves \$1,500 gross profit.

3. Which cost is excluded?

**D. Operating expenses**

The brief includes unit product cost but explicitly excludes operating expenses.

#### D Language checks / page 18

1. Which statement correctly combines the price and volume effects?

**C. Revenue rose 2%.**

The new quantity factor 1.20 multiplied by price factor 0.85 gives revenue factor 1.02.

2. What happened to gross profit?

**D. It fell from \$2,000 to \$1,500.**

Baseline gross profit is 100 times \$20; promotion gross profit is 120 times \$12.50.

3. How many promotional units would match baseline gross profit?

**D. 160**

The \$2,000 baseline divided by \$12.50 unit gross profit requires 160 units.

4. Which claim goes beyond the supplied evidence?

**D. The campaign acquired profitable new customers.**

No customer-acquisition or customer-profitability evidence is supplied by the weekly sales figures.

## 02 Conversation answers

### Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

#### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. unit volume.** Turn 2. Unit volume counts units sold; the twenty-percent increase does not alone establish revenue or profit improvement.
- 2. Sales revenue.** Turn 4. Sales revenue is price multiplied by units here; it rose from five thousand to five thousand one hundred dollars.
- 3. cost of goods sold.** Turn 6. Cost of goods sold includes thirty dollars for each sold unit, rising as unit volume increases.
- 4. gross profit.** Turn 8. Gross profit subtracts product costs from revenue; the resulting amounts are two thousand and fifteen hundred dollars.
- 5. unit gross profit.** Turn 10. Unit gross profit subtracts the thirty-dollar product cost from each selling price, producing twenty dollars and twelve fifty.
- 6. break-even volume.** Turn 12. Break-even volume here is explicitly the quantity needed to match prior gross profit, not company-wide net-profit break-even.
- 7. baseline.** Turn 14. Baseline identifies the reference week against which this promotion is compared, not proof of wider customer benefits.
- 8. funding allowance.** Turn 16. Funding allowance is supplier support under agreed terms; an unconfirmed possibility must not be booked as an established benefit.
- 9. gross margin percentage.** Turn 18. Gross margin percentage divides gross profit by revenue; fifteen hundred over fifty-one hundred is approximately twenty-nine point four percent.
- 10. margin dilution.** Turn 20. Margin dilution names the reduction in the profit margin, allowing a balanced account alongside the higher sales volume.

#### F Transfer conversation

Page 21

##### 1. 4,000

Manager: "Baseline revenue was 4,000 dollars."

Fifty units multiplied by eighty dollars yields four thousand dollars of revenue.

##### 2. 4,200

Analyst: "Promotion revenue was 4,200 dollars."

Sixty units multiplied by seventy dollars yields four thousand two hundred dollars.

##### 3. 1,500

Manager: "Baseline gross profit was 1,500 dollars."

Fifty units times the thirty-dollar unit gross profit gives fifteen hundred dollars.

##### 4. 1,200

Analyst: "Promotion gross profit was 1,200 dollars."

Sixty units times the twenty-dollar unit gross profit gives twelve hundred dollars.

# 03 Briefing and language checks

## Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

03

### A Briefing checks / page 22

1. How many warehouse units are available for new sales?

**A. 30**

One hundred on-hand units less sixty committed and ten held leaves thirty available.

2. How many incoming units are included in the on-hand total?

**D. None**

The brief explicitly separates twenty incoming units from the one hundred physically on hand.

3. What is established for Store East?

**B. It has no units.**

Store East has zero units, so warehouse stock cannot establish local pickup readiness.

### D Language checks / page 27

1. Which website claim is supported now?

**B. Store East has no stock for pickup.**

The local store has no units; the warehouse total does not change that fact.

2. Which arithmetic matches warehouse availability?

**C. 100 minus 60 minus 10 equals 30.**

Both existing commitments and the quality hold must be removed from the on-hand total.

3. Which step requires a separate check?

**B. Whether the warehouse can fulfill the customer's delivery route**

The brief leaves delivery eligibility unconfirmed despite the warehouse having thirty available units.

4. Which wording overstates a proposed transfer?

**B. The replenishment has arrived at Store East.**

A proposed stock movement does not establish physical receipt at the receiving store.

# 03 Conversation answers

## Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

03

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

**1. inventory snapshot.** Turn 2. Inventory snapshot fixes the quantity and status at a particular time; these records describe the position at nine.

**2. on-hand inventory.** Turn 4. On-hand inventory includes all physically held units in this case, including commitments and units on quality hold.

**3. incoming inventory.** Turn 6. Incoming inventory is expected stock not yet received; it must not be counted as already held at this warehouse.

**4. quality hold.** Turn 8. Quality hold restricts the ten units pending review; commercial demand does not itself authorize their release.

**5. committed inventory.** Turn 10. Committed inventory is allocated to existing demand and cannot be treated as unassigned stock for another sale.

**6. fulfillment eligibility.** Turn 12. Fulfillment eligibility establishes whether this item and warehouse may serve the proposed order and delivery route.

**7. stock reservation.** Turn 14. Stock reservation assigns stock to a particular demand; a general available balance does not establish that assignment.

**8. inventory feed.** Turn 16. Inventory feed supplies stock information to the website; its location and state mapping must support the displayed promise.

**9. transfer order.** Turn 18. Transfer order records an authorized inter-location movement; it does not prove the receiving store already has the goods.

**10. location-level availability.** Turn 20. Location-level availability ties sellable quantities to a specific site, preventing warehouse inventory from implying local pickup readiness.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 30

#### 1. 30

Trader: "The available warehouse quantity is 30."

Eighty on hand minus forty-five committed and five held leaves thirty available.

#### 2. five

Controller: "The held quantity is five."

The briefing explicitly identifies five units as held rather than available for sale.

#### 3. twelve

Trader: "The incoming quantity is twelve."

Twelve units are expected separately and are not part of on-hand stock.

#### 4. zero

Controller: "Store South's current quantity is zero."

The warehouse quantities do not change Store South's explicitly stated zero stock.

# 04 Briefing and language checks

## Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

04

### A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What is confirmed?

**A. The carrier physically received the order on 4 May.**

Physical handoff on 4 May is established; delivery and remedies remain unconfirmed.

2. What does 14:00 today represent?

**C. A status update**

The agent promises a communication update, not any unconfirmed shipment or financial outcome.

3. What is unknown?

**D. The revised arrival time**

The carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time in the supplied record.

### D Language checks / page 36

1. Which response is both honest and useful?

**A. The carrier has no confirmed new arrival; I will investigate and update you at 14:00.**

The supported response combines the real uncertainty with an action and a communication commitment.

2. Which event proves shipment in this case?

**D. Physical carrier handoff on 4 May**

The briefing establishes actual carrier possession, not merely preparation or an estimated future event.

3. Which promise is not supported?

**A. A replacement will arrive tomorrow.**

Neither replacement authorization nor a replacement arrival date is supplied.

4. What should a pending-carrier update do?

**D. State that the reply is pending and identify the continuing action.**

An honest update preserves the commitment without fabricating an answer or excluding applicable rights.

# 04 Conversation answers

## Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. estimated delivery date.** Turn 2. Estimated delivery date names the projected arrival that has passed; it is not proof that delivery occurred.
- 2. carrier handoff.** Turn 4. Carrier handoff means the parcel was physically transferred to the transport provider, which is established for 4 May.
- 3. delivery window.** Turn 6. Delivery window identifies an expected or scheduled arrival interval; no revised interval is confirmed here.
- 4. carrier inquiry.** Turn 8. Carrier inquiry is the concrete request for shipment investigation that the agent is authorized to initiate.
- 5. tracking event.** Turn 10. Tracking event is a recorded shipment milestone; checking it supports an update without guaranteeing a future arrival.
- 6. replacement order.** Turn 12. Replacement order supplies another item, but this record contains no authorization for the agent to promise one.
- 7. refund authorization.** Turn 14. Refund authorization is approval for returning payment; the agent must not imply an approval that the record lacks.
- 8. delivery exception.** Turn 16. Delivery exception identifies an interruption to the expected process; it requires investigation rather than an invented lost-parcel finding.
- 9. service recovery.** Turn 18. Service recovery concerns addressing the customer experience after the delay, including accountable follow-up and checking available remedies.
- 10. dispatch.** Turn 20. Dispatch concerns sending the goods; it must remain separate from the still-unconfirmed arrival at the customer's address.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 39

#### 1. 12 June

Agent: "Carrier handoff occurred on 12 June."

Twelve June is the confirmed physical handoff date, not the estimated arrival.

#### 2. 14 June

Customer: "The original estimated arrival was 14 June."

Fourteen June is the supplied estimate that has already passed.

#### 3. unconfirmed

Agent: "The revised arrival time remains unconfirmed."

No new arrival time is established by the facts in this exchange.

#### 4. 16:00

Customer: "The next status update is at 16:00."

Sixteen hundred is the contact commitment and must not become a delivery guarantee.

04

# 05 Briefing and language checks

## Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

### A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is the later conversion rate?

**D. 32%**

Three hundred twenty completed purchasing sessions divided by one thousand eligible sessions equals thirty-two percent.

2. What is the absolute rate decline?

**D. Eight percentage points**

Forty percent minus thirty-two percent is eight percentage points.

3. Which causal conclusion is established?

**D. The cause is not isolated by this before-and-after comparison.**

The outage and unverified comparability prevent this comparison from isolating one cause.

### D Language checks / page 45

1. Which sentence uses the correct units?

**D. Conversion fell eight percentage points, a twenty-percent relative decline.**

The absolute difference is eight points; eight divided by the original forty is twenty percent.

2. Which denominator belongs in this report?

**D. Eligible checkout sessions**

The briefing explicitly defines conversion using the eligible checkout-session base.

3. Which statement overclaims causality?

**A. The redesign caused the entire decline.**

A concurrent outage and unverified comparability leave the redesign's isolated effect unresolved.

4. Which diagnostic is useful but not automatically causal proof?

**B. Compare outage-affected intervals with unaffected intervals while checking their differences.**

Segment comparisons can reveal patterns, but differing populations or timing may still complicate causality.

# 05 Conversation answers

## Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

**1. checkout conversion.** Turn 2. Checkout conversion uses completed purchasing sessions over eligible checkout sessions, giving forty percent before and thirty-two percent after.

**2. percentage points.** Turn 4. Percentage points express the absolute difference between the forty-percent and thirty-two-percent rates.

**3. denominator.** Turn 6. Denominator is the rate's base; equal base counts do not guarantee equal populations, conditions, or measurement.

**4. provider outage.** Turn 8. Provider outage names the concurrent service disruption that complicates attributing the whole decline to the redesign.

**5. traffic mix.** Turn 10. Traffic mix describes the composition of sessions; differences between intervals can complicate interpreting their conversion rates.

**6. event instrumentation.** Turn 12. Event instrumentation is the collection implementation; a change can alter what is recorded even when behavior is unchanged.

**7. deduplication.** Turn 14. Deduplication handles repeated records; the session-based definition also requires counting each purchasing session at most once.

**8. device segment.** Turn 16. Device segment groups sessions by device type, allowing the team to locate patterns hidden by the aggregate rate.

**9. rollback.** Turn 18. Rollback returns to an earlier version; deciding on it requires the relevant operational risks and evidence, not a fabricated causal certainty.

**10. causal attribution.** Turn 20. Causal attribution assigns an outcome to a cause; this comparison supports an observed decline but not an isolated redesign effect.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 48

#### 1. 50%

Lead: "The original rate was 50%."

Three hundred purchasing sessions divided by six hundred eligible sessions equals fifty percent.

#### 2. 40%

Analyst: "The later rate was 40%."

Two hundred forty purchasing sessions divided by six hundred eligible sessions equals forty percent.

#### 3. ten percentage points

Lead: "The absolute decline was ten percentage points."

Fifty percent minus forty percent is an absolute ten-percentage-point difference.

#### 4. 20%

Analyst: "The relative decline was 20%."

Ten percentage points divided by the original fifty-percent rate equals a twenty-percent relative decline.

# 06 Briefing and language checks

## Marketplace and Vendor Management

### A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is Vendor K's defective-unit rate?

**D. 1.25%**

Ten defective units divided by eight hundred received units equals one point two five percent.

2. What is Vendor M's defective-unit rate?

**C. 2.5%**

Five defective units divided by two hundred received units equals two point five percent.

3. What remains unverified?

**D. Comparable product mix and inspection intensity**

The brief explicitly leaves product mix and inspection intensity unconfirmed as comparable.

### D Language checks / page 54

1. Which ranking is arithmetically correct?

**D. K has a lower defective-unit rate than M.**

K's 1.25% rate is below M's 2.5% rate on the stated received-unit bases.

2. If one unit has three faults, how is it counted here?

**C. As one defective unit**

The case explicitly counts each defective unit once regardless of its number of faults.

3. Which claim still needs investigation?

**A. K has better inherent quality under comparable conditions.**

Product mix and inspection intensity may differ, so inherent comparative quality is not established.

4. Which action is not authorized merely by the scorecard?

**B. Deducting a chargeback from the supplier's invoice**

Commercial deductions require their applicable terms and basis, not just a performance label.

# 06 Conversation answers

## Marketplace and Vendor Management

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

**1. received units.** Turn 2. Received units supply the stated rate denominator; ten and five alone are counts rather than rates.

**2. defective-unit rate.** Turn 4. Defective-unit rate divides defective units by received units here, yielding 1.25 percent for K and 2.5 percent for M.

**3. reporting period.** Turn 6. Reporting period fixes both numerator and denominator to July receipts so the comparison does not mix intervals.

**4. defect count.** Turn 8. Defect count counts individual faults; several faults on one unit must not become several defective units in this metric.

**5. product mix.** Turn 10. Product mix describes the goods included; different products can limit a claim about inherent comparative supplier quality.

**6. inspection record.** Turn 12. Inspection record supplies traceable findings and examination details needed to investigate the reported defective units.

**7. root cause.** Turn 14. Root cause is the supported underlying reason; the conversation supplies only an unconfirmed packaging hypothesis.

**8. chargeback.** Turn 16. Chargeback is a commercial deduction or charge whose basis must follow the applicable agreement, not the scorecard alone.

**9. remediation plan.** Turn 18. Remediation plan sets out actions addressing the problem once the evidence supports what needs to change.

**10. vendor scorecard.** Turn 20. Vendor scorecard should present defined measures accurately while leaving unresolved cause and commercial questions visible.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 57

#### 1. 1%

Manager: "P's defective-unit rate is 1%."

Six divided by six hundred equals one percent on the specified received-unit basis.

#### 2. 2%

Supplier: "Q's defective-unit rate is 2%."

Four divided by two hundred equals two percent on the specified received-unit basis.

#### 3. P

Manager: "The larger defective-unit count belongs to P."

P has six defective units compared with Q's four, so its count is larger.

#### 4. Q

Supplier: "The higher defective-unit rate belongs to Q."

Q's two-percent rate exceeds P's one-percent rate despite Q's smaller defective-unit count.

# 07 Briefing and language checks

## Customer Service and Escalations

### A Briefing checks / page 58

1. Why does Owen want to return the jacket?

**B. He changed his mind.**

The briefing specifies a change of mind and supplies no fault or misdescription allegation.

2. What can Elena authorize herself?

**C. Submission of a manager review, not approval of the exception**

Elena can submit the request but does not hold the stated exception-approval authority.

3. How should the 30-day policy be treated?

**D. As a stated policy that does not override applicable rights**

The policy informs the request, but actual customer rights and transaction facts still require checking.

### D Language checks / page 63

1. Which sentence stays within Elena's authority?

**B. I can submit a manager review, but I cannot guarantee its outcome.**

Elena can submit the request but cannot approve or promise the review result.

2. Which record best matches the stated request?

**C. Change of mind; unworn jacket; day 35; \$80 purchase**

The first record preserves the actual reason, condition, timing, and amount without inventing an outcome.

3. Which response to a newly alleged fault is appropriate?

**B. Record the allegation and assess the applicable rights and process separately.**

A fault allegation raises a different assessment and cannot be decided merely from this change-of-mind policy.

4. Which phrase asks permission without implying approval?

**C. Would you like me to submit the review?**

The question offers a specific submission action while leaving the review decision unmade.

# 07 Conversation answers

## Customer Service and Escalations

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

**1. change-of-mind return.** Turn 2. Change-of-mind return accurately identifies Owen's stated reason, rather than inventing a fault or misdescription.

**2. return window.** Turn 4. Return window is the retailer's stated thirty-day period for this purchase, not a universal legal limit.

**3. goodwill exception.** Turn 6. Goodwill exception is a permitted discretionary departure from policy; requesting it does not establish approval or replace applicable rights.

**4. manager review.** Turn 8. Manager review is the assessment step Elena can submit; its result is not supplied or guaranteed.

**5. store credit.** Turn 10. Store credit is value for a future purchase; it also requires an actual available or approved basis here.

**6. proof of purchase.** Turn 12. Proof of purchase identifies the transaction and its details, supporting the review without requiring a fabricated outcome.

**7. exception authority.** Turn 14. Exception authority identifies who may approve a policy departure; Elena's submission does not transfer that decision power to her.

**8. fault allegation.** Turn 16. Fault allegation is a reported defect requiring its own assessment; it must not be automatically rejected under the goodwill window.

**9. complaint record.** Turn 18. Complaint record preserves the customer's actual concern, supplied details, and handling without turning a request into an approved remedy.

**10. service handoff.** Turn 20. Service handoff transfers accurate context and responsibility, including the distinction between a submitted review and its eventual outcome.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 66

#### 1. 22

Noor: "The request is on day 22."

Twenty-two is the request day stated for this separate transaction.

#### 2. 14

Customer: "The stated policy window is 14 days."

Fourteen days is the fictional policy period, not an invented universal legal rule.

#### 3. Beth

Noor: "The manager reviewing the request is Beth."

Beth is the named manager; Noor only submits the review.

#### 4. approval

Customer: "Submission does not guarantee approval."

A submitted review is not the same as an approved exception or remedy.

# 08 Briefing and language checks

## Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

### A Briefing checks / page 67

1. Which item has not been located?

**A. The mug**

The briefing identifies the mug as missing while the other two items are staged.

2. What does the local whole-order ready status require?

**B. Every ordered item verified and staged**

The local rule requires all ordered items, not just part of the order, to be verified and staged.

3. Who owns the next customer contact?

**B. Evan**

Evan is the incoming lead assigned to contact the customer and update the case.

### D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handoff is actionable?

**D. P64: two items staged, mug missing, ready status incorrect; Evan contacts customer and updates at 16:30.**

The detailed handoff preserves physical facts, the system mismatch, responsibility, and the next checkpoint.

2. Which substitution claim is supported?

**C. No substitute has been approved.**

The briefing explicitly leaves substitution unapproved and does not supply customer consent.

3. What does 16:30 mean?

**B. A case-update checkpoint**

Sixteen thirty is the scheduled update, not proof of any particular resolution outcome.

4. Which record would invent an event?

**A. Marking the missing mug as collected because staff cannot find it**

Failure to locate an item is not evidence that the customer collected it.

# 08 Conversation answers

## Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

### E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. order-level status.** Turn 2. Order-level status describes the whole order; ready is unsupported when one of the three required items is missing.
- 2. staging.** Turn 4. Staging places the picked items in the holding area; it confirms preparation of two items, not completion of all three.
- 3. pickup notification.** Turn 6. Pickup notification communicates collection readiness; an inaccurate ready message needs correction and direct customer follow-up.
- 4. partial pickup.** Turn 8. Partial pickup supplies only part of the order and needs the permitted process plus the customer's agreement here.
- 5. substitution.** Turn 10. Substitution provides a different item; the nearby mug cannot replace the ordered one without the necessary approval and agreement.
- 6. short pick.** Turn 12. Short pick identifies the unfulfilled picking quantity, keeping the missing mug visible instead of treating the order as complete.
- 7. action owner.** Turn 14. Action owner identifies Evan as responsible for the next customer contact, preventing the task from being lost between shifts.
- 8. refund status.** Turn 16. Refund status records the actual payment-return stage; a cancellation request or missing item does not itself establish a completed refund.
- 9. discrepancy log.** Turn 18. Discrepancy log preserves the mismatch between physical items and system status, together with ownership and follow-up information.
- 10. resolution checkpoint.** Turn 20. Resolution checkpoint is the scheduled progress review at sixteen thirty, not an automatic completion or refund event.

### F Transfer conversation

Page 75

#### 1. C17

Outgoing lead: "The order reference is C17."

C17 identifies the particular pickup order that needs the handoff.

#### 2. desk lamp

Jun: "The missing item is the desk lamp."

The desk lamp is the unstaged item, not one of the three already prepared.

#### 3. Jun

Outgoing lead: "The next contact owner is Jun."

Jun is explicitly assigned responsibility for contacting the customer after the handoff.

#### 4. 18:00

Jun: "The next case update is at 18:00."

Eighteen hundred is the update checkpoint, not a guaranteed completion time.

08

# Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

## 01 Merchandising and Assortment Planning

**Open the comparison:** Both ranges generated \$12,000 in the same four weeks.

**State the remaining exposure:** Range B still has eighty units on hand.

**Ask for the missing basis:** Can we add product costs before comparing gross profit?

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

## 02 Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

**Acknowledge volume:** The promotion sold twenty percent more units.

**Keep the cost basis:** Product cost stayed at thirty dollars per unit.

**Name the exclusion:** This calculation excludes operating and promotional expenses.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

## 03 Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

**Identify the item:** We are checking SKU L42.

**Protect existing orders:** Sixty units are already committed.

**Correct the promise:** The warehouse total must not drive a ready-for-pickup message here.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

## 04 Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

**Acknowledge the missed estimate:** The estimated date has passed, and you still do not have the order.

**Avoid an unsupported date:** I do not have a confirmed revised arrival time.

**Check the latest event:** I will confirm what the tracking record actually shows.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

# Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

## 05 Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

**State the observed result:** Checkout conversion fell from forty to thirty-two percent.

**Define the counted outcome:** We count a session once if it completes a purchase.

**Request a measurement check:** Has event collection remained consistent across the release?

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

## 06 Marketplace and Vendor Management

**Ask for the base:** What received-unit denominator is behind this rate?

**Correct the label:** Ten is a count, not a percentage.

**Check comparability:** Were product mix and inspection intensity comparable?

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

## 07 Customer Service and Escalations

**Acknowledge the request:** You would like to return the unworn jacket because you changed your mind.

**Keep rights separate:** We also need to check the rights applicable to the actual transaction.

**Request relevant evidence:** Please provide the purchase details through our approved process.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

## 08 Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

**Start with the order:** This handoff concerns pickup order P64.

**Identify the contradiction:** The website says ready, but the order is incomplete.

**Reject an assumed substitute:** No substitute has been approved.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                                                   |    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>acceptance criterion</b> confirm the acceptance criterion      | 51 |
| <b>action owner</b> name the action owner                         | 69 |
| <b>allocation</b> revise the allocation                           | 23 |
| <b>applicable rights</b> check applicable rights                  | 60 |
| <b>assortment</b> review the assortment                           | 5  |
| <b>assortment breadth</b> broaden the assortment                  | 5  |
| <b>assortment depth</b> adjust assortment depth                   | 5  |
| <b>available inventory</b> confirm available inventory            | 23 |
| <b>available to promise</b> calculate available to promise        | 23 |
| <b>average order value</b> monitor average order value            | 15 |
| <b>backorder</b> manage a backorder                               | 24 |
| <b>baseline</b> establish a baseline                              | 14 |
| <b>basket value</b> increase basket value                         | 15 |
| <b>break-even volume</b> calculate break-even volume              | 15 |
| <b>buy online, pick up in store (BOPIS)</b> fulfill a BOPIS order | 68 |
| <b>buying budget</b> protect the buying budget                    | 6  |
| <b>cancellation line</b> confirm a cancellation line              | 69 |
| <b>cannibalization</b> assess cannibalization                     | 15 |
| <b>carrier handoff</b> verify carrier handoff                     | 32 |
| <b>carrier inquiry</b> open a carrier inquiry                     | 32 |
| <b>case owner</b> identify the case owner                         | 60 |
| <b>catalog attribute</b> correct a catalog attribute              | 51 |
| <b>causal attribution</b> qualify causal attribution              | 42 |
| <b>change-of-mind return</b> handle a change-of-mind return       | 59 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                |                                   |    |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----|
| <b>channel allocation</b>      | review channel allocation         | 24 |
| <b>chargeback</b>              | dispute a vendor chargeback       | 50 |
| <b>checkout abandonment</b>    | investigate checkout abandonment  | 41 |
| <b>checkout conversion</b>     | measure checkout conversion       | 41 |
| <b>click and collect</b>       | manage click-and-collect orders   | 68 |
| <b>cohort</b>                  | define a cohort                   | 42 |
| <b>collection verification</b> | complete collection verification  | 69 |
| <b>colorway</b>                | add a colorway                    | 6  |
| <b>committed inventory</b>     | protect committed inventory       | 23 |
| <b>complaint record</b>        | maintain a complaint record       | 60 |
| <b>confounder</b>              | identify a confounder             | 42 |
| <b>consignment</b>             | identify the consignment          | 32 |
| <b>content compliance</b>      | review content compliance         | 51 |
| <b>contribution margin</b>     | define contribution margin        | 14 |
| <b>controlled experiment</b>   | run a controlled experiment       | 42 |
| <b>conversion funnel</b>       | examine the conversion funnel     | 41 |
| <b>core line</b>               | replenish a core line             | 6  |
| <b>cost of goods sold</b>      | deduct cost of goods sold         | 14 |
| <b>customer consent</b>        | obtain customer consent           | 69 |
| <b>customer segment</b>        | serve a customer segment          | 6  |
| <b>cycle count</b>             | perform a cycle count             | 24 |
| <b>deduplication</b>           | validate deduplication            | 41 |
| <b>defect count</b>            | distinguish the defect count      | 50 |
| <b>defective-unit rate</b>     | calculate the defective-unit rate | 50 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                                                  |    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>delist</b> propose a delisting                                | 6  |
| <b>delivery attempt</b> verify a delivery attempt                | 33 |
| <b>delivery exception</b> investigate a delivery exception       | 32 |
| <b>delivery window</b> confirm the delivery window               | 32 |
| <b>denominator</b> keep the denominator consistent               | 41 |
| <b>device segment</b> analyze a device segment                   | 42 |
| <b>discount depth</b> compare discount depth                     | 15 |
| <b>discrepancy log</b> update the discrepancy log                | 69 |
| <b>dispatch</b> confirm dispatch                                 | 32 |
| <b>dispute evidence</b> submit dispute evidence                  | 51 |
| <b>duplicate event</b> remove duplicate events                   | 41 |
| <b>eligible session</b> define eligible sessions                 | 41 |
| <b>escalation route</b> offer an escalation route                | 60 |
| <b>estimated delivery date</b> revise an estimated delivery date | 32 |
| <b>event instrumentation</b> audit event instrumentation         | 41 |
| <b>exception authority</b> confirm exception authority           | 59 |
| <b>exchange</b> authorize an exchange                            | 59 |
| <b>fault allegation</b> record a fault allegation                | 60 |
| <b>friction</b> reduce checkout friction                         | 42 |
| <b>fulfillment</b> track order fulfillment                       | 32 |
| <b>fulfillment eligibility</b> check fulfillment eligibility     | 24 |
| <b>full-price sale</b> protect full-price sales                  | 5  |
| <b>funding allowance</b> verify a funding allowance              | 15 |
| <b>goodwill exception</b> request a goodwill exception           | 59 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                         |                                    |    |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----|
| <b>gross margin percentage</b>          | calculate gross margin percentage  | 14 |
| <b>gross margin return on inventory</b> | evaluate inventory return          | 6  |
| <b>gross profit</b>                     | protect gross profit               | 14 |
| <b>halo effect</b>                      | test for a halo effect             | 15 |
| <b>incoming inventory</b>               | track incoming inventory           | 23 |
| <b>incremental revenue</b>              | estimate incremental revenue       | 14 |
| <b>inspection intensity</b>             | compare inspection intensity       | 50 |
| <b>inspection record</b>                | retrieve the inspection record     | 51 |
| <b>inventory adjustment</b>             | authorize an inventory adjustment  | 24 |
| <b>inventory feed</b>                   | correct the inventory feed         | 23 |
| <b>inventory snapshot</b>               | timestamp the inventory snapshot   | 24 |
| <b>item condition</b>                   | assess item condition              | 59 |
| <b>item-level status</b>                | update item-level status           | 68 |
| <b>last mile</b>                        | coordinate last-mile delivery      | 32 |
| <b>lead time</b>                        | verify replenishment lead time     | 24 |
| <b>location-level availability</b>      | verify location-level availability | 23 |
| <b>lot</b>                              | trace the affected lot             | 51 |
| <b>manager review</b>                   | submit a manager review            | 59 |
| <b>margin dilution</b>                  | quantify margin dilution           | 15 |
| <b>markdown</b>                         | take a markdown                    | 5  |
| <b>marketplace listing</b>              | update the marketplace listing     | 51 |
| <b>misdescription</b>                   | investigate misdescription         | 60 |
| <b>omnichannel</b>                      | coordinate omnichannel execution   | 68 |
| <b>on-hand inventory</b>                | reconcile on-hand inventory        | 23 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                                                   |    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>open-to-buy</b> check open-to-buy                              | 6  |
| <b>opening stock</b> establish opening stock                      | 5  |
| <b>option count</b> review the option count                       | 5  |
| <b>order management system (OMS)</b> update the OMS               | 68 |
| <b>order-level status</b> correct order-level status              | 69 |
| <b>original payment method</b> verify the original payment method | 59 |
| <b>overselling</b> prevent overselling                            | 24 |
| <b>partial fulfillment</b> record partial fulfillment             | 33 |
| <b>partial pickup</b> arrange partial pickup                      | 69 |
| <b>payment failure</b> investigate payment failures               | 42 |
| <b>payment gateway</b> monitor the payment gateway                | 42 |
| <b>percentage point</b> report a percentage-point change          | 41 |
| <b>pick list</b> verify the pick list                             | 68 |
| <b>picking</b> complete order picking                             | 68 |
| <b>pickup notification</b> correct a pickup notification          | 69 |
| <b>pickup shelf</b> check the pickup shelf                        | 68 |
| <b>point of sale (POS)</b> reconcile POS records                  | 68 |
| <b>policy discretion</b> explain policy discretion                | 60 |
| <b>price elasticity</b> estimate price elasticity                 | 15 |
| <b>price override</b> approve a price override                    | 15 |
| <b>price reduction</b> apply a price reduction                    | 14 |
| <b>product mix</b> control for product mix                        | 50 |
| <b>promotion mechanic</b> explain the promotion mechanic          | 15 |
| <b>promotional uplift</b> measure promotional uplift              | 14 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                |                                 |    |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|----|
| <b>proof of delivery</b>       | request proof of delivery       | 32 |
| <b>proof of purchase</b>       | verify proof of purchase        | 59 |
| <b>provider outage</b>         | isolate the provider outage     | 42 |
| <b>purchase channel</b>        | identify the purchase channel   | 59 |
| <b>purchase event</b>          | validate the purchase event     | 41 |
| <b>purchase order</b>          | reconcile the purchase order    | 50 |
| <b>quality hold</b>            | maintain a quality hold         | 23 |
| <b>random assignment</b>       | verify random assignment        | 42 |
| <b>range</b>                   | compare product ranges          | 5  |
| <b>range rationalization</b>   | support range rationalization   | 6  |
| <b>range review</b>            | conduct a range review          | 6  |
| <b>ready-for-pickup status</b> | correct ready-for-pickup status | 68 |
| <b>reason code</b>             | select the correct reason code  | 60 |
| <b>received units</b>          | confirm received units          | 50 |
| <b>redemption rate</b>         | calculate redemption rate       | 15 |
| <b>refund</b>                  | confirm a refund                | 59 |
| <b>refund authorization</b>    | confirm refund authorization    | 33 |
| <b>refund status</b>           | verify refund status            | 69 |
| <b>relative change</b>         | calculate relative change       | 41 |
| <b>remediation plan</b>        | agree a remediation plan        | 51 |
| <b>reorder point</b>           | set a reorder point             | 24 |
| <b>replacement order</b>       | authorize a replacement order   | 33 |
| <b>replenishment</b>           | schedule replenishment          | 23 |
| <b>reporting period</b>        | specify the reporting period    | 50 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                |                                    |    |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------|----|
| <b>residual stock</b>          | reduce residual stock              | 5  |
| <b>resolution checkpoint</b>   | set a resolution checkpoint        | 69 |
| <b>resolution option</b>       | verify resolution options          | 60 |
| <b>restocking fee</b>          | explain a restocking fee           | 33 |
| <b>return authorization</b>    | issue a return authorization       | 33 |
| <b>return inspection</b>       | complete a return inspection       | 33 |
| <b>return to sender</b>        | investigate return to sender       | 33 |
| <b>return to vendor</b>        | authorize a return to vendor       | 51 |
| <b>return window</b>           | check the return window            | 59 |
| <b>reverse logistics</b>       | manage reverse logistics           | 33 |
| <b>review outcome</b>          | communicate the review outcome     | 60 |
| <b>rollback</b>                | evaluate a rollback                | 42 |
| <b>root cause</b>              | establish the root cause           | 50 |
| <b>safety stock</b>            | review safety stock                | 24 |
| <b>sales revenue</b>           | calculate sales revenue            | 14 |
| <b>sample size</b>             | state the sample size              | 51 |
| <b>seasonal line</b>           | exit a seasonal line               | 6  |
| <b>sell-through</b>            | calculate unit sell-through        | 5  |
| <b>seller of record</b>        | identify the seller of record      | 51 |
| <b>selling price</b>           | set the selling price              | 14 |
| <b>service handoff</b>         | complete a service handoff         | 60 |
| <b>service level</b>           | verify the service level           | 32 |
| <b>service recovery</b>        | coordinate service recovery        | 33 |
| <b>service-level agreement</b> | review the service-level agreement | 51 |

# Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

|                                                                      |    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| <b>shift handoff</b> give a shift handoff                            | 69 |
| <b>short pick</b> record a short pick                                | 68 |
| <b>size curve</b> revise the size curve                              | 5  |
| <b>split shipment</b> explain a split shipment                       | 33 |
| <b>staging</b> confirm order staging                                 | 68 |
| <b>statutory remedy</b> distinguish a statutory remedy               | 60 |
| <b>stock reservation</b> confirm a stock reservation                 | 24 |
| <b>stock turn</b> compare stock turn                                 | 6  |
| <b>stock-keeping unit (SKU)</b> rationalize the SKU count            | 5  |
| <b>stockout</b> report a store stockout                              | 23 |
| <b>store credit</b> explain store credit                             | 59 |
| <b>substitution</b> confirm a substitution                           | 69 |
| <b>supplier corrective action</b> request supplier corrective action | 50 |
| <b>tracking event</b> check the latest tracking event                | 32 |
| <b>tracking number</b> provide the tracking number                   | 33 |
| <b>traffic mix</b> compare traffic mix                               | 41 |
| <b>transfer order</b> create a transfer order                        | 24 |
| <b>unavailable inventory</b> classify unavailable inventory          | 23 |
| <b>unit gross profit</b> compare unit gross profit                   | 14 |
| <b>unit volume</b> increase unit volume                              | 14 |
| <b>user experience (UX)</b> assess the user experience               | 42 |
| <b>vendor allowance</b> verify a vendor allowance                    | 50 |
| <b>vendor scorecard</b> correct a vendor scorecard                   | 50 |
| <b>weeks of cover</b> assess weeks of cover                          | 6  |

# Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

## **[1] Federal Trade Commission. Business Guide to the Mail, Internet, or Telephone Order Merchandise Rule.**

[Open the original source](#)

Background on shipment promises and delay obligations. Shipment and delivery are distinguished; the fictional carrier-delay case is not a complete legal procedure. Checked 1 October 2026.

## **[2] Shopify Help Center. Understanding inventory states.**

[Open the original source](#)

Background on on-hand, available, committed, unavailable, and incoming quantities. The fictional inventory case states its own quantities and location scope. Checked 1 October 2026.

## **[3] Google Analytics Help. About ecommerce metrics.**

[Open the original source](#)

Background on event-level and item-level measures. The checkout case explicitly defines its own denominator rather than implying a universal platform conversion metric. Checked 1 October 2026.

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## **Phil Stilwell**

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